

May 2025

Newzoo's Motivational Gamer Personas Handbook



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Table of contents

[1. Introduction](#)

[2. Newzoo's Motivational Gamer Personas](#)

[3. Guiding development, promotions, and retention](#)

[4. Detailed persona profiles](#)

[5. Using the Global Gamer Study to help you thrive](#)

Introduction

We are delighted to again include **Newzoo's Motivational Gamer Personas** in this year's [Global Gamer Study](#). This **exciting resource** is a way to help game makers understand and empathize with audiences, build better products for them, communicate with them more directly, and learn how to maintain engagement:

- Learn what drives different players to engage with certain genres, games, features or mechanics
- Understand how motivations overlap (e.g., which personas are closely related to each other)
- Discover where to find and how to communicate with players who play for specific (and different) reasons

Newzoo's Motivational Gamer Personas are also helpful 'audience building blocks', included within the data:

- Increase precision: pick the personas you wish to target and enhance further with other data points.
- Widen reach: group like-minded personas or stretch your audience using secondary or tertiary personas.

What's more, this year's [Game Health Tracker](#) now includes over a year of tracked games, each with its own persona profile. This means that – alongside describing gamers in immense detail via our [Global Gamer Study](#) – we also now show who is playing the games themselves on a continuous basis in the [Game Health Tracker](#)!

In the pages that follow, you will find an outline of our methodology, an introduction to each persona (including updated details on some of their most important behaviors and attitudes), and examples of how game makers might use this resource to help boost the success of their games.

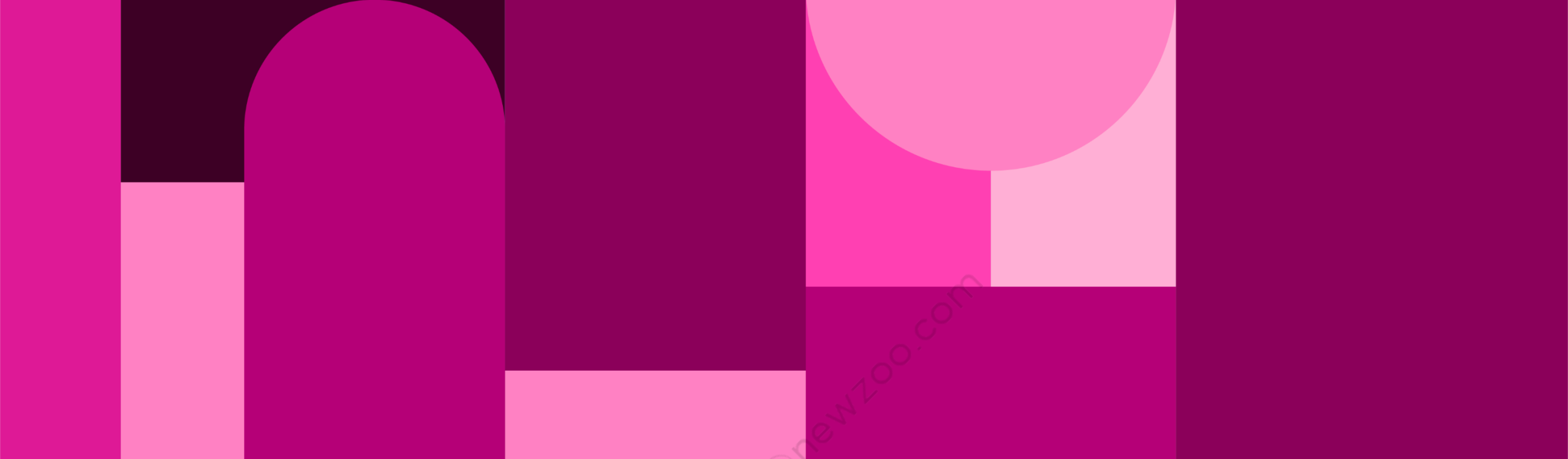
We hope you find it useful!



Alexis Pamboris
Research Director



Mary Brune
Head of Consumer Insights



Newzoo's Motivational Gamer Personas

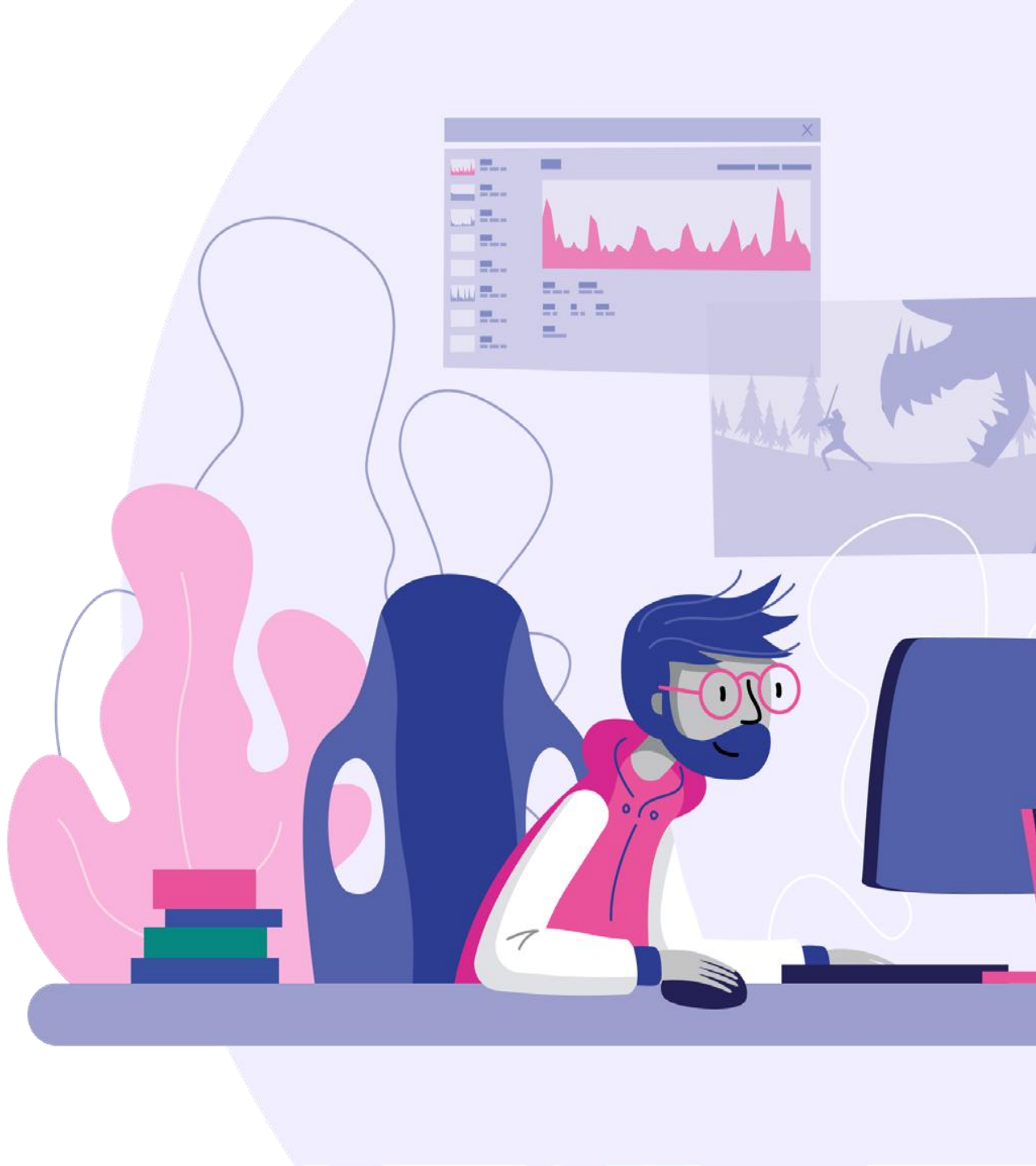
Introductions and methodology

Newzoo's Motivational Gamer Personas are created from the combinations of reasons players give for playing games

Why use motivations? Because players cite common and underlying reasons to play games, but the way these combine and interact vary depending on the player, the scenarios they play in, the games available to them, and even the state of the games industry at the time.

Motivational personas help you to focus on and empathize with your audiences through a holistic lens, showing prevailing gaming preferences alongside demographics, pastimes, social media, TV subscriptions, and other factors. This helps you make games, features, mechanics, and messaging that appeal directly to them.

The next slide provides an overview of all ten personas, including motivational statements and the share of PC and console players each one of them represents.



Introducing Newzoo's Motivational Gamer Personas



Motivations are seemingly endless, but there are common underlying themes

To uncover these motivational themes, we reviewed our vast library of international research projects, many of which include proven player motivation and attitudinal questions. We also looked at industry and academic literature on gaming motivations.

We conducted qualitative interviews with gamers, mining their reasons for playing and asking how they change depending on moods, gaming scenarios, and over their gaming lives. We also held discussions with developers and publishers interested in new ways to understand players.

From this, we created 42 motivational statements, which we tested in a survey covering a wide range of markets and player types, with different cultural responses to gaming and surveys.

We used Factor Analysis to understand the correlation between the 42 statements. This enabled us to distill them into a manageable task for respondents to undertake in surveys, including our [Global Gamer Study](#) and [Game Health Tracker](#).

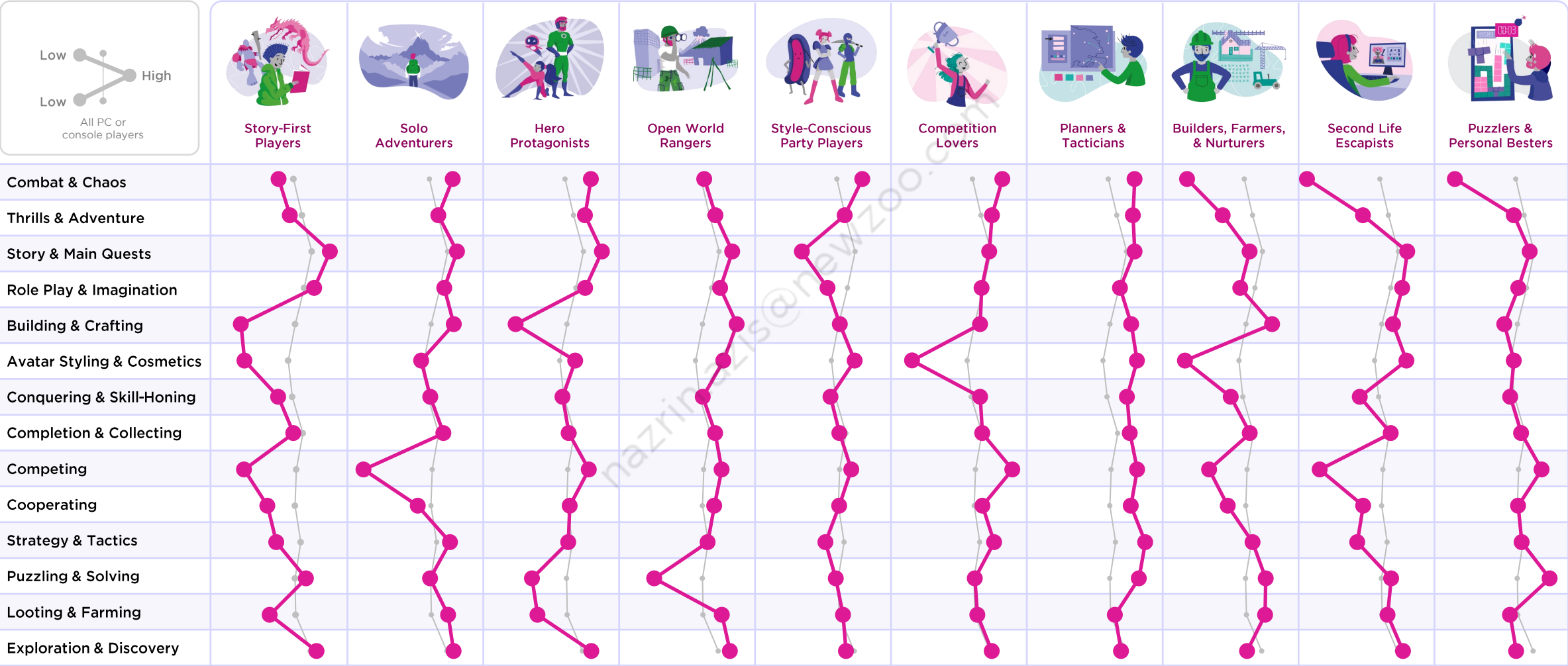
The 14 motivational categories you see to the right are the result:

Action:	Combat & Chaos	Thrills & Adrenaline
Immersion:	Story & Main Quests	Role Play & Imagination
Expression:	Building & Crafting	Avatar Styling & Cosmetics
Mastering:	Completion & Collecting	Conquering & Skill-Honing
Social:	Competing	Cooperating
Thinking:	Strategy & Tactics	Puzzling and Solving
Tasking:	Looting & Farming	Exploration & Discovery



If you know what a game offers, it's easy to tell who might like it

Motivational profiles show what each persona might look for in a game.



In our design, we allow for the fact that people can change

Different motivations may be more important to players at different times, especially with so many options available nowadays. We therefore assign up to three personas per player: a “primary,” “secondary,” and “tertiary” persona.

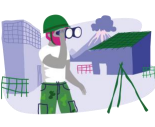
This flexibility allows us to easily see which groups are likely to be closer to one another when it comes to certain behaviors and preferences.

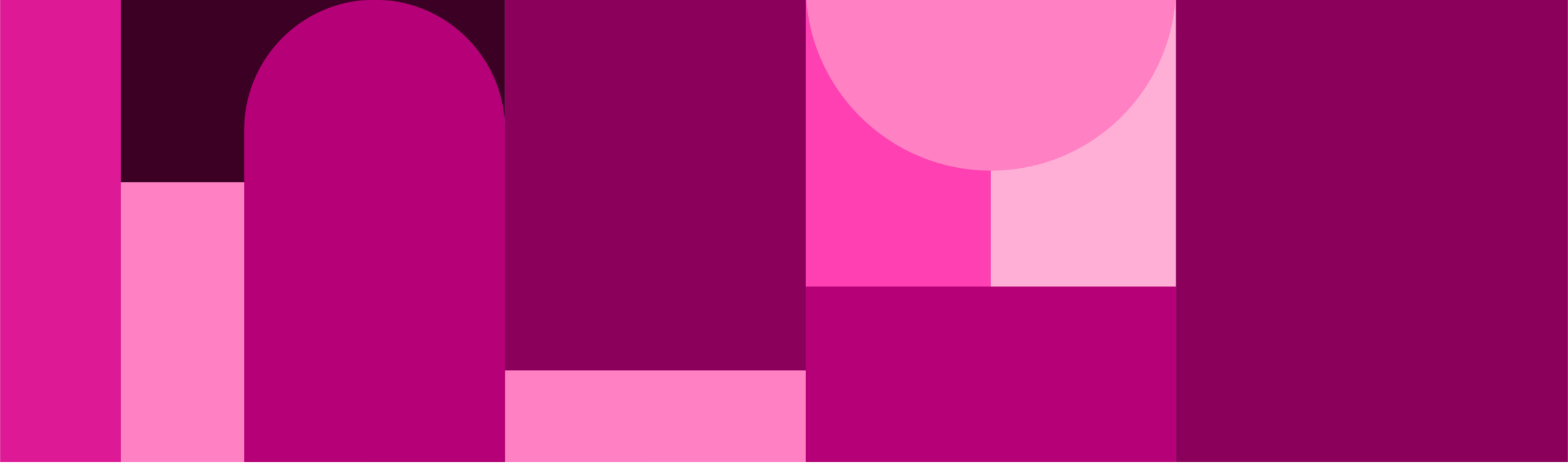
This lets us add players to certain analysis’ that might otherwise have been excluded, for example a stretch for an addressable audience estimate, or selecting a wider pool of secondary personas, who might be open to a particular game concept.



Players can be more than one persona... because people are like that!

People change and may align themselves with a different persona at different times. This makes personas more like moods or mindsets, which is fine: they are characters made from complex human behaviors and motivations. They are presented as personalities so game makers can focus on creating products and messaging for them.

	 Story-First Players	 Solo Adventurers	 Hero Protagonists	 Open World Rangers	 Style-Conscious Party Players	 Competition Lovers	 Planners & Tacticians	 Builders, Farmers, & Nurturers	 Second Life Escapists	 Puzzlers & Personal Besters
Main persona share:	8%	8%	12%	11%	12%	14%	13%	6%	7%	9%
Increase from 2 nd and 3 rd personas:	+5 ppt	+6 ppt	+7 ppt	+11 ppt	+10 ppt	+6 ppt	+8 ppt	+6 ppt	+4 ppt	+5 ppt
Max. persona share:	13%	14%	19%	22%	22%	20%	21%	12%	11%	14%
Top 3 crossover personas:	Hero Protagonists Solo Adventurers Competition lovers	Builders, Farmers, & Nurturers Story-First Players Open Word Rangers	Story-First Players Open World Rangers Planners & Tacticians	Hero Protagonists Style- Conscious Party Players Solo Adventurers	Planners & Tacticians Open World Rangers Hero Protagonists	Builders, Farmers, & Nurturers Planners & Tacticians Hero Protagonists	Style-Conscious Party Players Puzzlers & Personal Besters Hero Protagonists	Solo Adventurers Puzzlers & Personal Besters Competition Lovers	Solo Adventurers Builders, Farmers, & Nurturers Story-First Players	Planners & Tacticians Builders, Farmers, & Nurturers Story-First Players



Guiding development, promotions, and retention

Using Newzoo's Motivational Gamer Personas with our [Global Gamer Study](#) and [Game Health Tracker](#)

Mapping personas to markets, genres, titles, settings, and themes helps game makers know “what to say and to whom.”

Players can (and do) enjoy multiple genres, some more than others. But strategic thinking is often required—it is not always about finding and hooking the biggest groups; targeting the most receptive ones usually makes for a higher-conversion marketing plan.

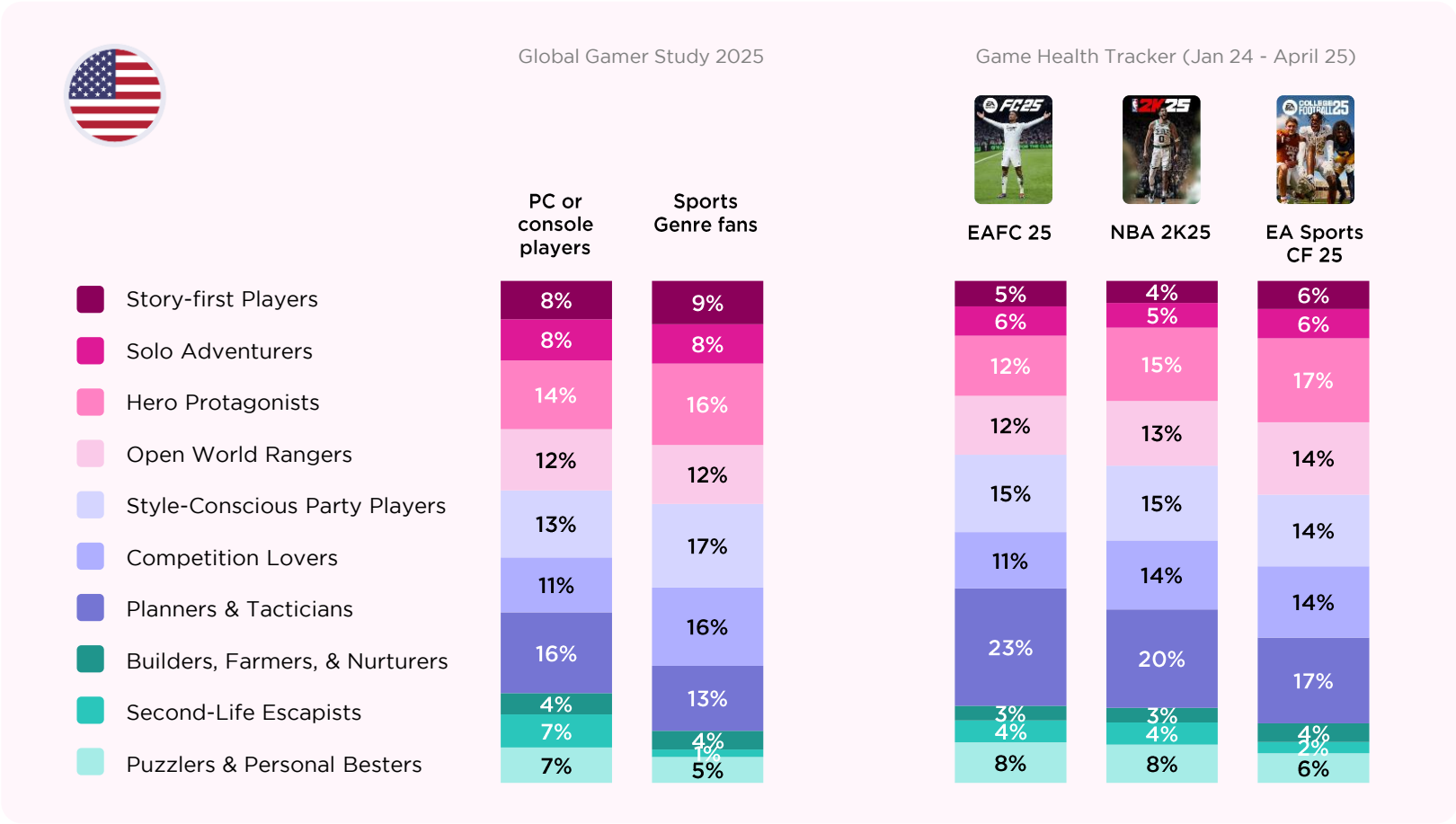
At this moment in gaming, where players’ time is dominated by a relatively small number of very large, often persistent, live-service titles, it is especially important to maximize conversion within the niches.



Check who is playing your game, and refine messaging for those who should be

Persona profiles: PC or Console Gamers, Sports Fans, and Selected titles (each in first three months of release)

PC or console players (combining gamer-level data from our [Global Gamer Study](#) and game-level data from our [Game Health Tracker](#))



The US has some of the most engaged consumers of PC and Console games, with many more multi-platform players, multi-genre players, and high spenders than the global average. These attributes are shared by Planners & Tacticians, so it is no surprise the US over-indexes on this group (16% compared to 13% across all markets).

Planners & Tacticians represent especially well for the well-established EA and 2K titles shown to the left. What is worth noting however, is how EA Sports College Football 25 attracts fewer of these players, despite arguably offering a wider range of strategic experiences than the other two games (e.g., recruitment management, play-calling trees, program-building layers, etc.).

Knowing who is missing your messaging is key to widening reach, especially if those players are likely to respond positively. Using the Global Gamer Study to learn about their pastimes and media touchpoints can only help with the precision of your communications.

Different personas want to hear about different features

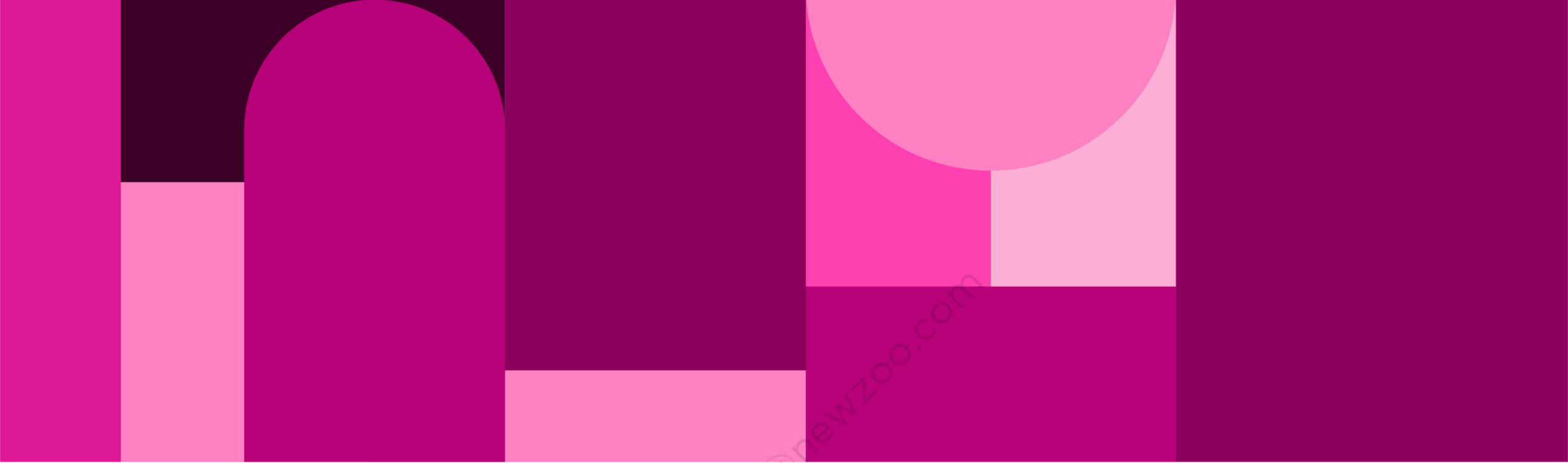
By asking players what they are **most and least** interested in hearing about from a new game, we can create a net score¹ to help prioritize development efforts or messaging. This naturally varies by persona (Builders, Second Lifers, and Solo Adventurers being uniquely interested in harvesting and loot, for example). However, it sometimes is the common interests that are most actionable: Hearing about quality graphics, a good story, the ability to explore and interesting design are high on the list for most, for example.

	PC or console players	Story-first Players	Solo Adventurers	Hero Protagonists	Open World Rangers	Style-Conscious Party Players	Competition Lovers	Planners & Tacticians	Builders, Farmers & Nurturers	Second-Life Escapists	Puzzlers & Personal Besters
High quality graphics	23%	26%	23%	31%	24%	21%	28%	17%	21%	20%	18%
Exploration and open worlds	16%	28%	23%	19%	19%	8%	16%	5%	21%	26%	7%
Narrative or story	15%	36%	22%	22%	13%	0%	11%	4%	16%	27%	12%
Interesting design or aesthetics	12%	15%	16%	15%	13%	6%	9%	6%	11%	21%	9%
Theme or setting	8%	14%	15%	10%	5%	4%	3%	5%	11%	13%	6%
Player choice	6%	12%	8%	8%	11%	3%	6%	2%	3%	13%	2%
PvP	6%	-13%	-15%	19%	14%	14%	23%	5%	-7%	-21%	6%
Art style	4%	8%	4%	6%	5%	-1%	0%	-1%	5%	16%	4%
Char' customization and creation	3%	0%	3%	7%	6%	2%	-1%	1%	-5%	14%	3%
Puzzle-solving aspects	3%	19%	4%	-17%	-16%	-2%	-1%	6%	27%	15%	18%
A single avatar they control	2%	3%	7%	5%	3%	2%	-4%	3%	1%	6%	-2%
High replay value	1%	3%	2%	1%	3%	1%	-2%	3%	-2%	-5%	-1%
Diversity of characters	0%	-6%	-3%	0%	3%	3%	-2%	1%	-4%	0%	1%
PvE	-1%	-7%	-5%	6%	2%	3%	5%	5%	-12%	-18%	-3%
Social or hangout support	-1%	-9%	-10%	3%	3%	1%	0%	1%	-8%	-7%	5%
Harvesting/collecting aspects	-1%	-5%	6%	-15%	-1%	-3%	-4%	-1%	15%	11%	-2%
Level creation tools	-2%	-9%	-2%	-6%	-2%	2%	-2%	-3%	0%	-2%	1%
Based on real-life sport or pastime	-2%	-7%	-9%	-2%	-3%	2%	1%	0%	-4%	-12%	1%
Soundtrack or sound design	-2%	3%	1%	-3%	-2%	-4%	-5%	-1%	-6%	1%	-6%
Elements of luck or chance	-3%	-6%	-5%	-9%	-1%	-1%	-3%	-2%	3%	-2%	-1%
Resource management aspects	-5%	-10%	0%	-13%	-5%	-6%	-5%	-5%	4%	-4%	-7%
Control over a squad	-6%	-14%	-5%	-5%	-9%	1%	2%	-1%	-12%	-22%	-6%

Every persona has distinct preferences for themes and settings

Survival is a popular theme, driven especially by enjoyment among Competition Lovers, Open World Rangers, Hero Protagonists, and Style Conscious Party Players. These latter two also find horror particularly appealing, while more peaceful natural settings and mysterious themes disproportionately draw Builders, Puzzlers, and Second Life Escapists. Second Life Escapists also standout for their enjoyment of fantasy, which is also a favorite for Stort-first players.

	PC or console players	Story-first Players	Solo Adventurers	Hero Protagonists	Open World Rangers	Style-Conscious Party Players	Competition Lovers	Planners & Tacticians	Builders, Farmers & Nurturers	Second-Life Escapists	Puzzlers & Personal Besters
Survival	37%	28%	36%	42%	45%	40%	46%	35%	30%	26%	30%
Fantasy	36%	41%	37%	35%	37%	34%	31%	34%	33%	48%	34%
Science fiction	30%	35%	33%	35%	31%	29%	32%	28%	26%	23%	26%
Mystery	29%	31%	27%	27%	27%	27%	28%	31%	33%	33%	34%
Horror	23%	24%	21%	29%	22%	27%	24%	25%	15%	17%	18%
Nature	22%	17%	19%	15%	21%	21%	18%	24%	28%	31%	28%
Historic	20%	22%	25%	17%	20%	17%	21%	20%	24%	17%	20%
Mythology	19%	21%	21%	19%	19%	16%	18%	18%	20%	22%	18%
Contemporary / modern day	15%	13%	15%	14%	16%	16%	15%	16%	17%	17%	16%
Post-apocalyptic	15%	17%	19%	19%	17%	12%	17%	13%	9%	10%	9%



Detailed persona profiles

How each persona differs to the average PC or console gamer



Story-First Players

"Tell me a story: often,
that's all I want"

Story-First Players care most about the narrative. They especially enjoy adventure and role-playing games, puzzles, and interactive stories. When they play games involving tons of choice, they tend to focus on main quests and are less likely to look for side quests, collectibles, or other non-critical tasks.

Story-First Players have a strong preference for single-player modes and especially enjoy fantasy, sci-fi, or mystery settings. Survival interests them, but more as a theme than a mechanic. They prefer PC or console and spend more money on gaming than most other players do (especially on console).

Despite this, Story-First Players have a lower overall affinity with the idea of being a gamer. They engage less with viewing and community discussions on games and are the least likely to buy additional in-game content. Outside gaming, Story-First Players enjoy TV, movies, music, and reading more than most other personas.

Story-First Players: demographics, playing, and paying



8%

Story-First Players

"Tell me a story: often, that's all I want"

Story-first Players are older and prefer PC or console more than most. They spend more money on console, with most of their budgets going on games. They are also the least likely persona to purchase items in-game, on both PC and console.

CLOSE COUSINS (BY CROSSOVER):

Hero Protagonists
Solo Adventurers
Second Life Escapists

DEMOGRAPHICS



1% Other/
non-binary



Ave. age:
34.0

All personas avg.: M: 60% / F: 40% / Age: 30.7

PLATFORMS USED (LAST 6 MONTHS)



65%
65%



65%
Console



65%
PC

All personas avg.: M: 65% / C: 64% / PC: 66%

FAVORITE PLATFORM

21%
Mobile

40%
Console

37%
PC

All personas avg.: M: 28% / C: 36% / PC: 34%

WEEKLY PLAY HOURS (LAST 6 MONTHS)

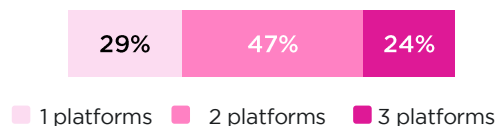
4.6
Mobile

4.7
Console

5.0
PC

All personas avg.: M: 5.4/ C: 4.9 / PC: 5.2

NUMBER OF PLATFORMS USED



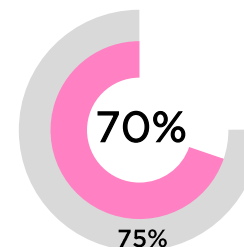
All personas avg.: 1: 29%, 2: 46%, 3: 25%

PAYERS (ANY PLATFORM, LAST 6 MONTHS)¹



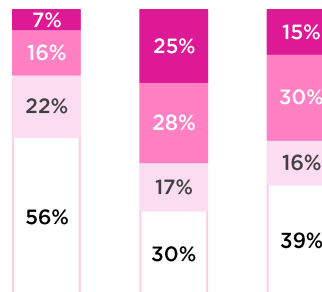
Story-First
Players

All personas
avg.



PAYING SEGMENT (PER PLATFORM)²

High spend



All personas avg.:

High: 11%
Med: 26%
Low: 24%
None: 39%

25%
32%
16%
28%

19%
31%
18%
33%

PC/ CONSOLE PURCHASES (LAST 6 MONTHS)

Subscriptions

29% **30%**

In-game/ MTX

41% **38%**

Games (boxed or DL)

73% **73%**



All personas avg.:

Subs:
In-game:
Games:

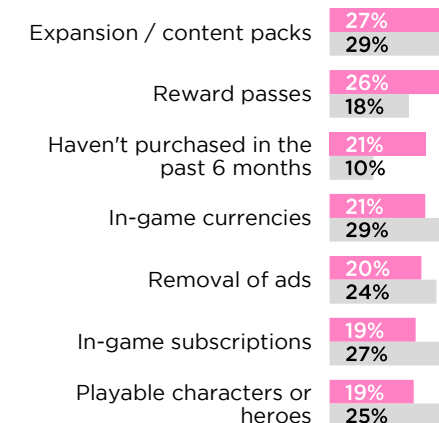
37%
49%
69%

35%
49%
74%

IN-GAME PURCHASES (LAST 6 MONTHS)

Story-First Players

All personas avg.



Story-First Players: play preferences



8%

Story-First Players

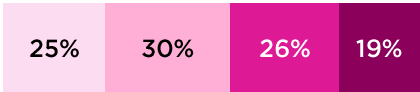
"Tell me a story: often, that's all I want"

Story-First Players enjoy adventures and puzzle-solving elements. Story and exploration are key, especially in fantasy, sci-fi, or mystery settings. Survival interests them, but more as a theme than a mechanic or feature.

TOP MOTIVATIONAL INPUTS:

Story, Exploration, Role Playing, Puzzle, Completion, Thrills, Combat

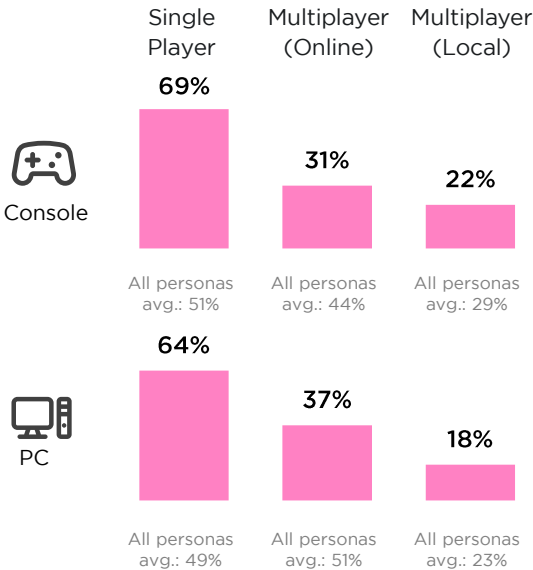
GAMER AFFINITY¹



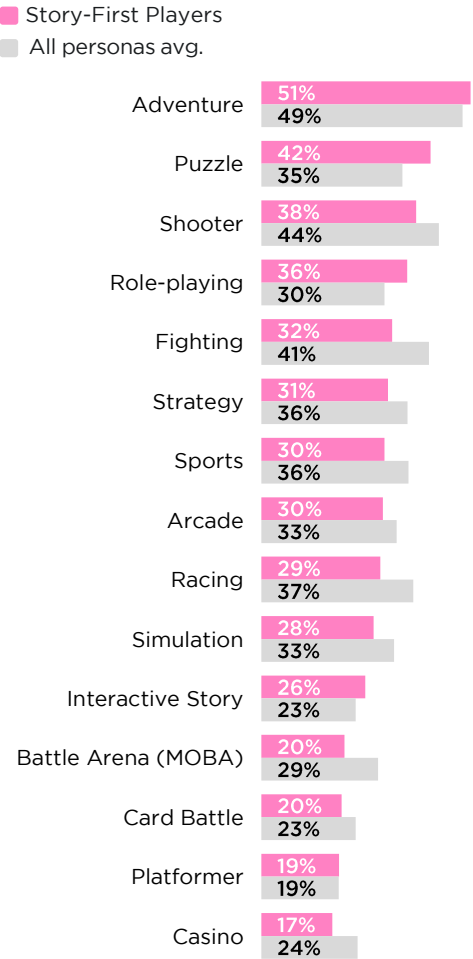
Low Mid-low Mid-high High

All personas avg.: L:17%, ML: 26%, HL: 30%, H: 28%

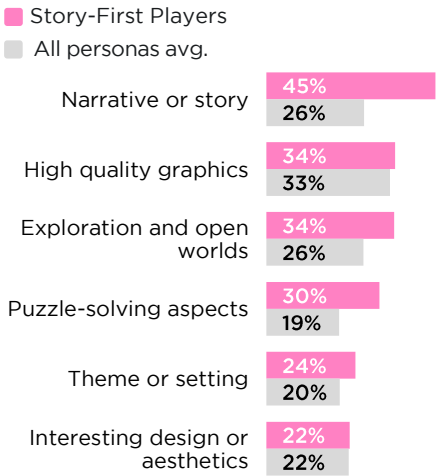
FAVORITE PC AND CONSOLE GAME MODES



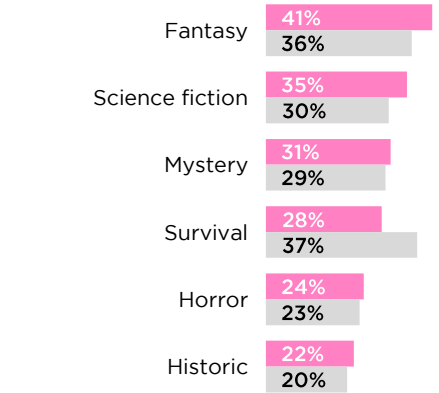
FAVORITE GENRES



MOST INTERESTING FEATURES



FAVORITE THEMES



Story-First Players: beyond playing



8%

Story-First Players

"Tell me a story: often, that's all I want"

Story-First Players engage less with viewing and other ways to enjoy gaming. Apart from X/Twitter and YouTube, they use social media less, but they do enjoy TV, movies, music, and reading more than most other personas.

MOST-REPRESENTED IN:

Japan, Russia, Spain, Finland Germany, France, Italy, Canada, Belgium, Poland United Kingdom

ENGAGEMENT BEYOND PLAY



View gaming content¹

67%



Engage other ways²

31%

All personas avg.: View: 76%, Other 40%

Very likely to explore other media related to favorite games **49%** Personas avg: 59%

Say media/ merch' positively influences gameplay or purchase **40%** Personas avg: 55%

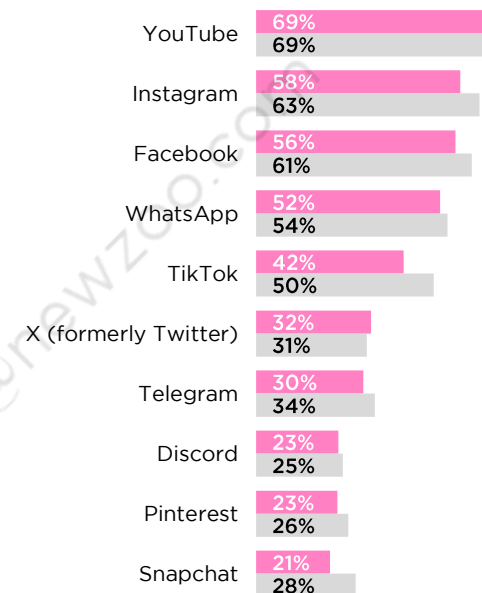
More likely to play a game featuring favorite entertainment brands **49%** Personas avg: 61%

Likely to pick up a game due to a TV show/movie from the franchise **49%** Personas avg: 60%

SOCIAL MEDIA USAGE

Story-First Players

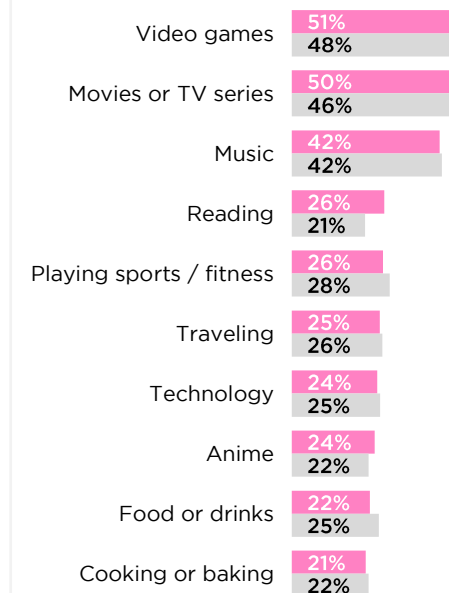
All personas avg.



FAVORITE PASTIMES

Story-First Players

All personas avg.



PERSONA SIZE BY MARKET

US	CA	GB	DE	FR	ES	IT	NL	BE	SE	FI	PL	RU	TR	SA	AE	EG	ZA
8%	10%	9%	12%	11%	12%	11%	8%	9%	7%	12%	10%	14%	5%	6%	5%	6%	7%
CN	JP	KR	TW	ID	PH	VN	SG	TH	MY	IN	BR	MX	AR	CO	CL	AU	NZ
5%	15%	6%	8%	5%	6%	5%	8%	5%	5%	6%	5%	5%	7%	5%	8%	8%	8%



Solo Adventurers

"Give me action, combat, story,
and exploration! ...but let me
do it at my own pace"

Solo Adventurers enjoy single-player games with lots of exploration, discovery, and optional tasks to do. They have a higher-than-average preference for immersive adventure, role-playing, and simulation games. If they pick up a multiplayer game, they are likely to play it solo, for example as a lone wolf in a survival or RPG title

The chances that a Solo Adventurer will identify as a gamer are relatively low, and they are a bit less likely to view gaming content or discuss games with friends (even though they are just as interested in cross-media as the average player).

An older group than average, they play on PC more each week and for longer than they do on console or mobile. Their likelihood to make in-game purchases is relatively low unless it is on expansion or content packs. Apart from YouTube, Facebook, and X/Twitter, they use social media less than other (often younger) personas.

Solo Adventurers: demographics, playing, and paying



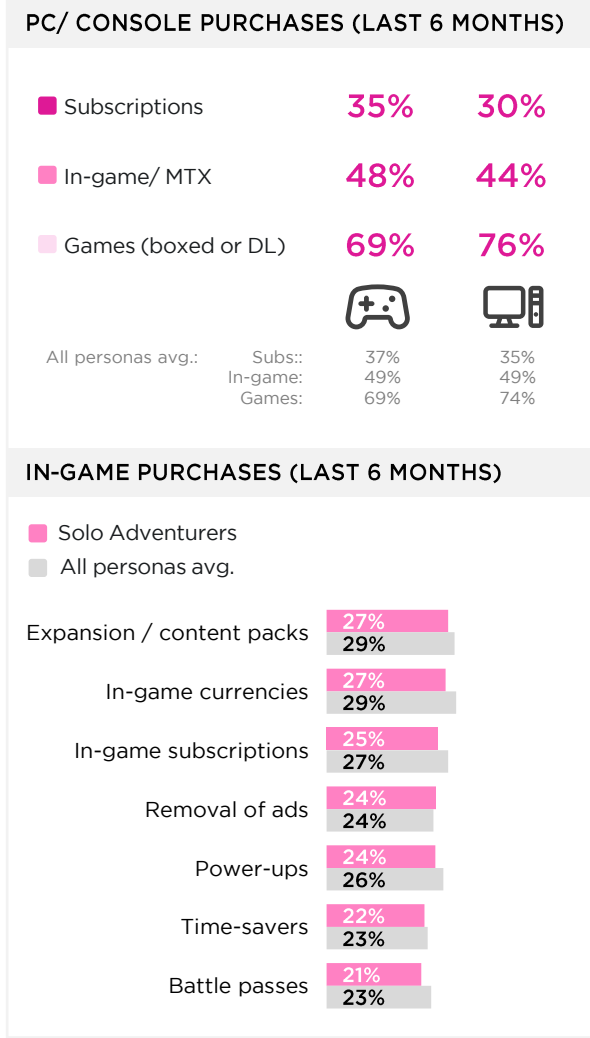
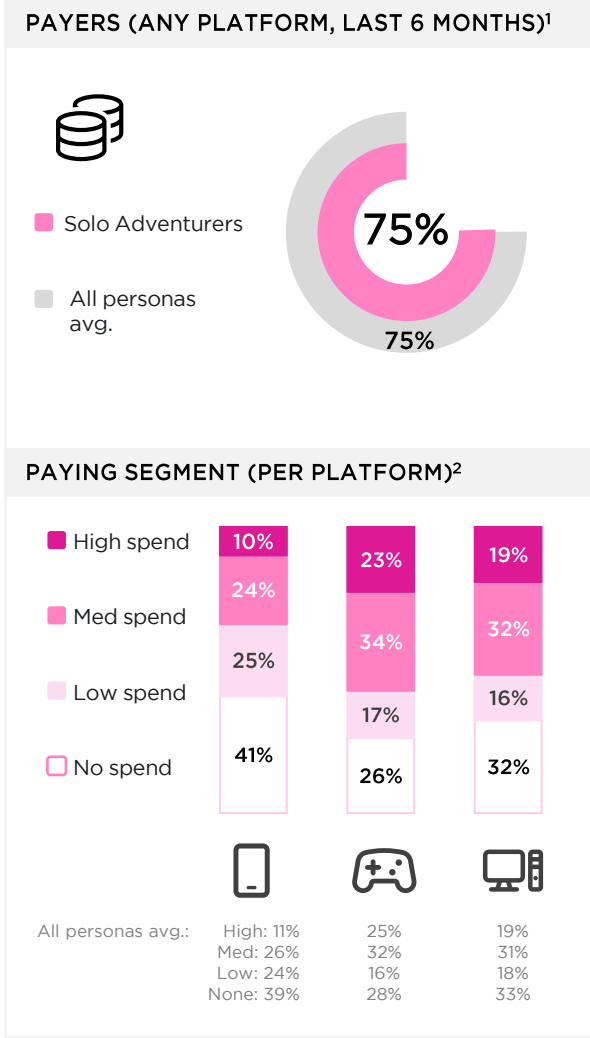
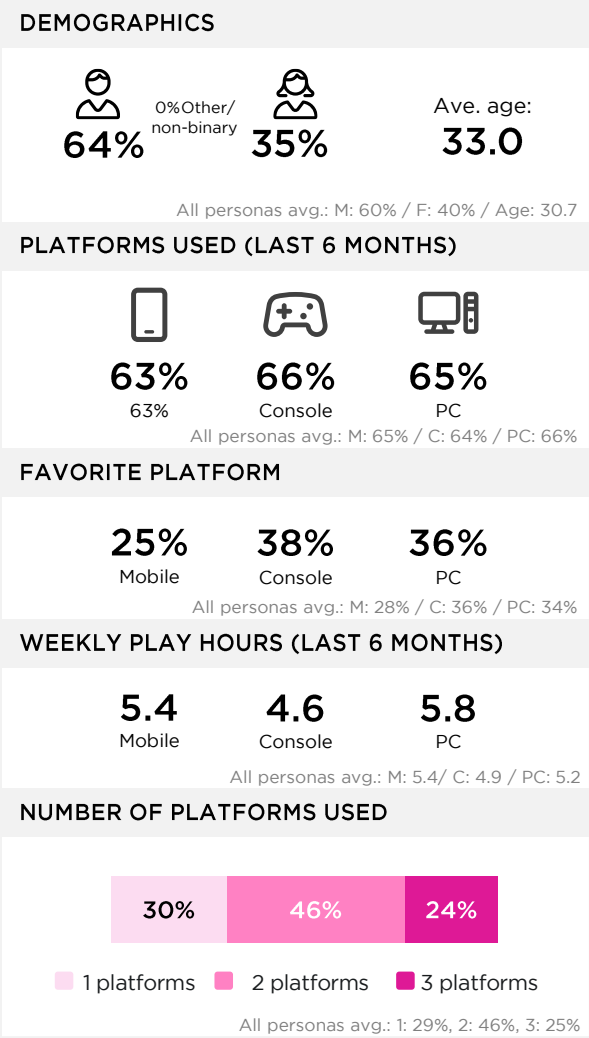
8%

Solo Adventurers

“Give me action, combat, story, and exploration! ...but let me do it at my own pace”

Solo Adventurers are an older group than average and play on PC more and for longer each week, than they play on console or mobile. Their likelihood to make in-game purchases is relatively low, unless it is on expansion or content packs.

- CLOSE COUSINS (BY CROSSOVER):
- Builders, Farmers, & Nurturers
 - Second Life Escapists
 - Story-First Players



Solo Adventurers: play preferences



8%

Solo Adventurers

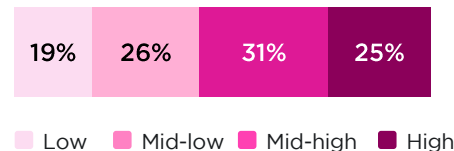
"Give me action, combat, story, and exploration! ...but let me do it at my own pace"

Solo Adventurers have a higher gamer affinity than Story-First Players, and enjoy Role Playing, Strategy, and Simulation games more than other players do. Story is important, but they are also interested in exploration and choice.

TOP MOTIVATIONAL INPUTS:

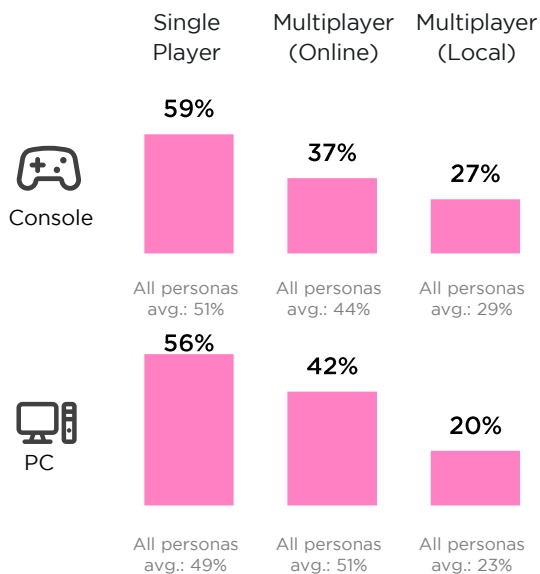
Story, Exploration, Building, Combat, Strategy, Role Playing, Looting

GAMER AFFINITY¹

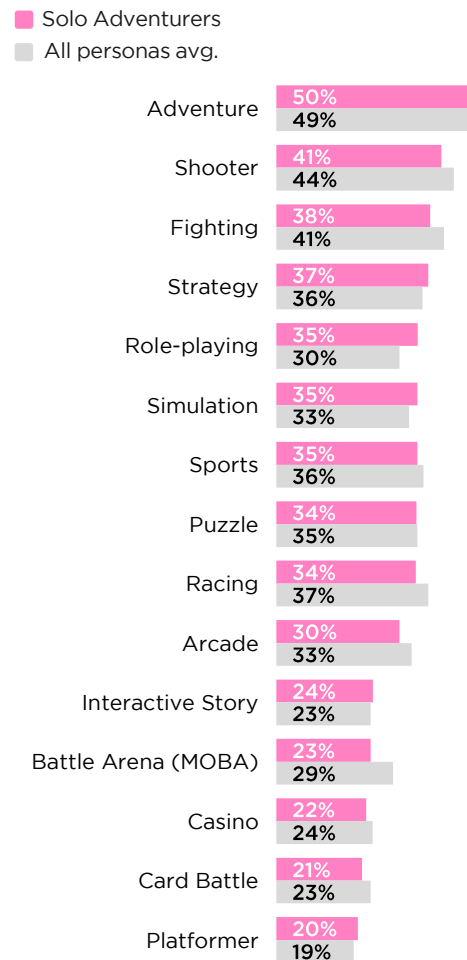


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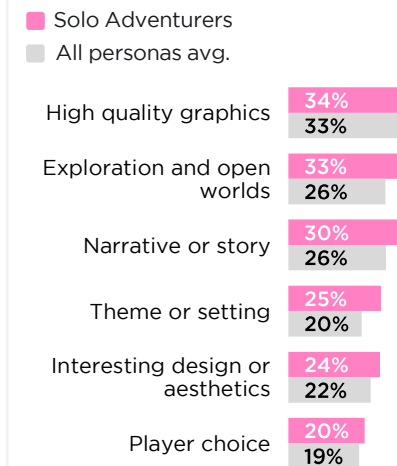
FAVORITE PC AND CONSOLE GAME MODES



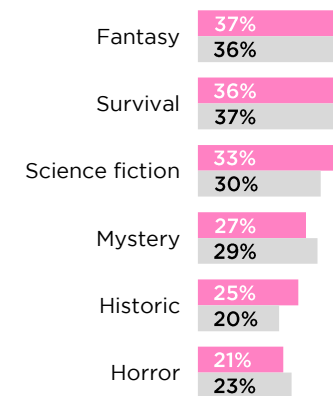
FAVORITE GENRES



MOST INTERESTING FEATURES



FAVORITE THEMES



Solo Adventurers: beyond playing



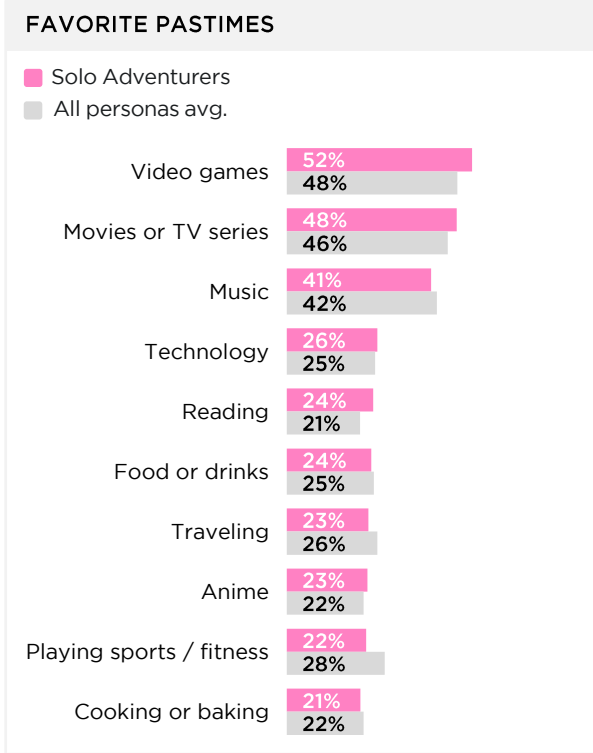
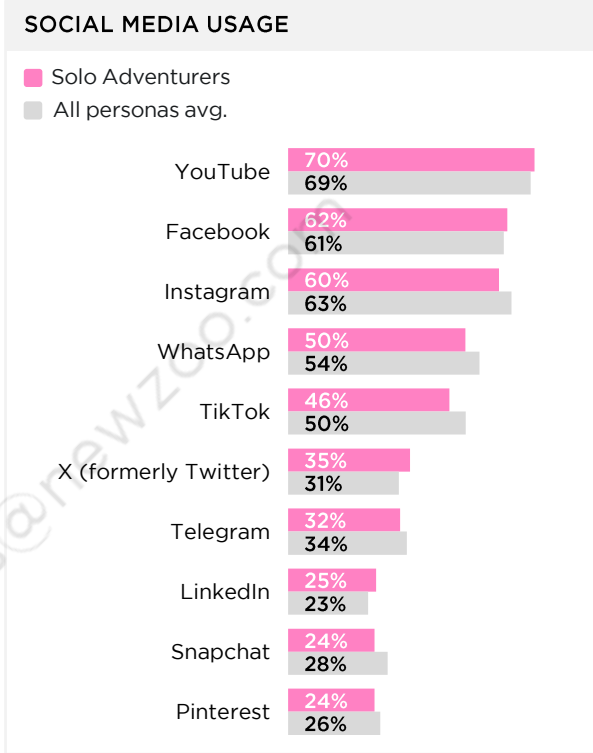
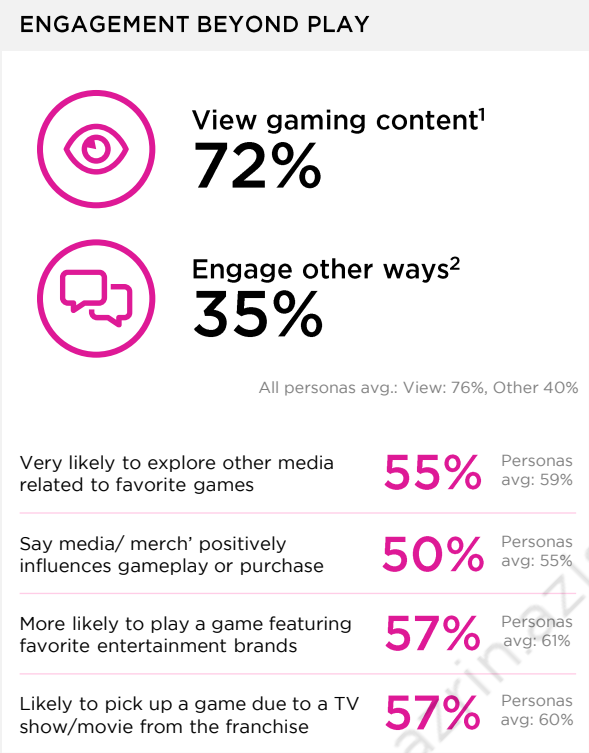
8%

Solo Adventurers

"Give me action, combat, story, and exploration! ...but let me do it at my own pace"

Solo Adventurers are a bit less likely to engage in gaming beyond play but are just as interested in cross-media as the average PC or console player. They enjoy games and reading more than average, but most other pastimes less.

MOST-REPRESENTED IN:
Japan, Canada, France, Finland, New Zealand, Poland, Sweden, Taiwan, Australia



PERSONA SIZE BY MARKET																			
US	CA	GB	DE	FR	ES	IT	NL	BE	SE	FI	PL	RU	TR	SA	AE	EG	ZA		
8%	10%	8%	6%	9%	6%	8%	5%	6%	9%	9%	9%	6%	7%	5%	6%	6%	5%		
CN	JP	KR	TW	ID	PH	VN	SG	TH	MY	IN	BR	MX	AR	CO	CL	AU	NZ		
7%	13%	7%	9%	7%	8%	7%	8%	7%	8%	7%	8%	6%	6%	6%	7%	8%	9%		



Hero Protagonists

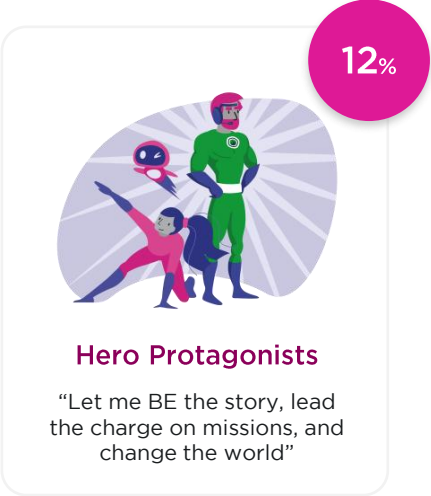
"Let me BE the story, lead the charge on missions, and change the world"

Hero Protagonists want to be at the center of events and to impact the game worlds they inhabit. They seek this feeling of agency in multiplayer games just as much as in single-player games (maybe even slightly more so). They enjoy nearly all genres more than the average PC or console player, but especially love adventure games, shooters, fighting, and MOBA titles.

As a relatively young group that skews male, they seem more invested in gaming than average and are more than comfortable being a labelled a gamer. They are likelier than most to pay for their gaming, with larger proportions of high spenders than other personas. As well as paying for games, they buy lots of extras and add-ons and are likelier than average to go for cosmetics, skins, and battle passes.

They can be found in higher-than-average numbers on most major social networks, but particularly TikTok and Snapchat.

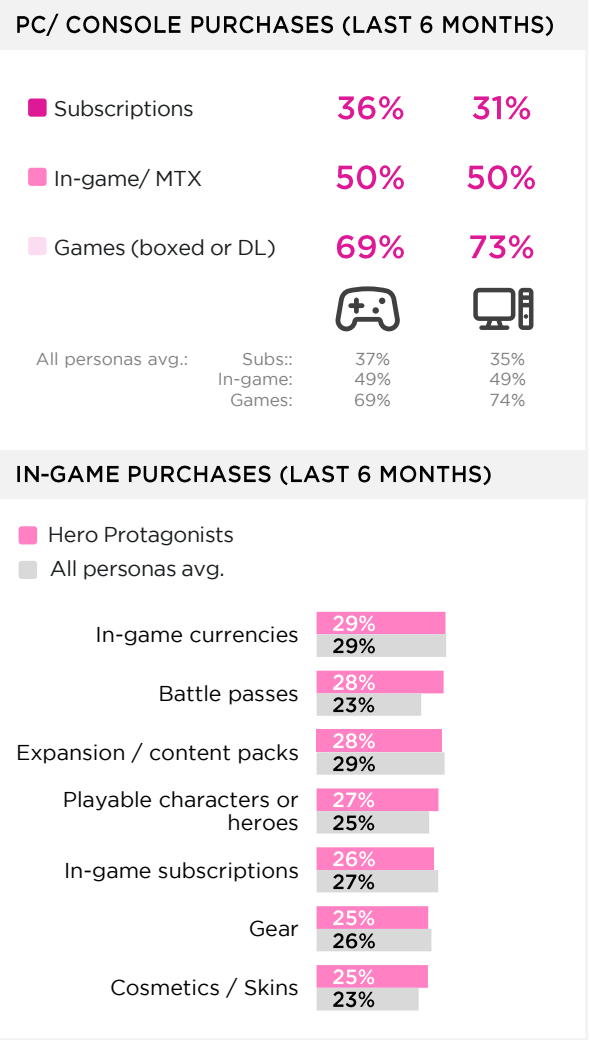
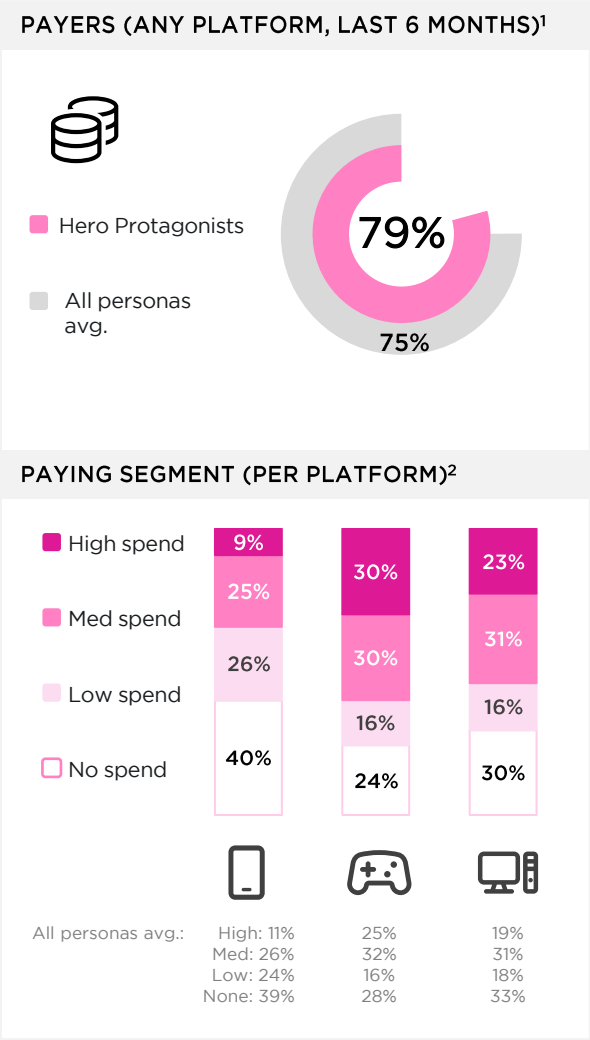
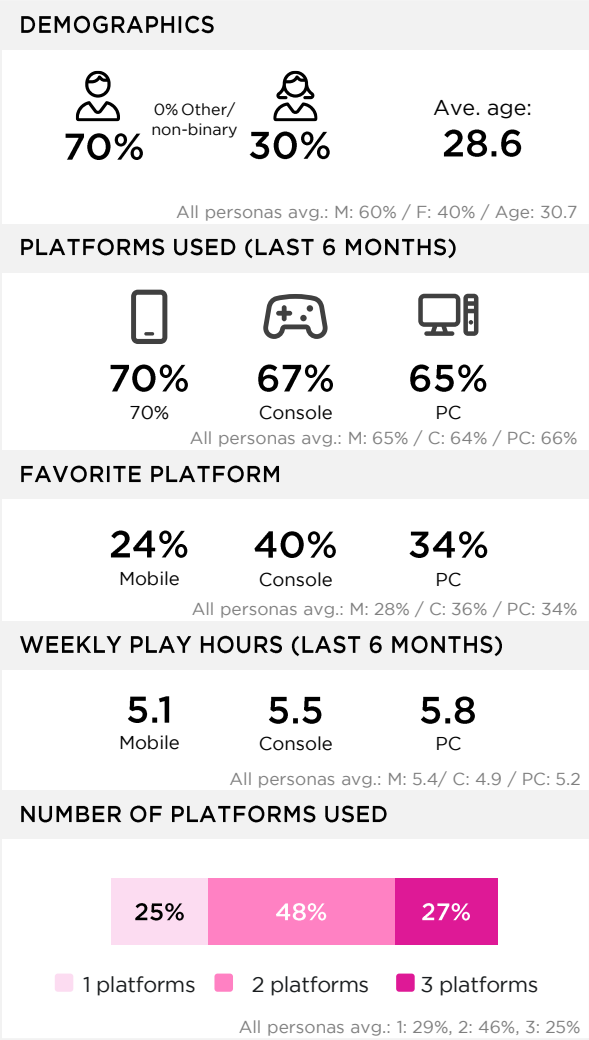
Hero Protagonists: demographics, playing, and paying



Hero Protagonists are a large, young group that skews male. They are often payers, with more PC and console high spenders than gamers in general. They buy lots of items, but are likelier than average to go for cosmetics, skins, and battle passes.

CLOSE COUSINS (BY CROSSOVER):

- Open World Rangers
- Planners & Tacticians
- Story-First Players



Hero Protagonists: play preferences



12%

Hero Protagonists

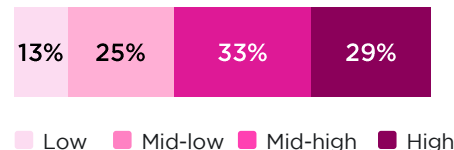
"Let me BE the story, lead the charge on missions, and change the world"

Hero Protagonists have a high gamer affinity and enjoy both multiplayer and solo games. They enjoy most genres more than the average gamer does, especially those offering agency, like adventure games, shooters, racing, role-playing, etc.

TOP MOTIVATIONAL INPUTS:

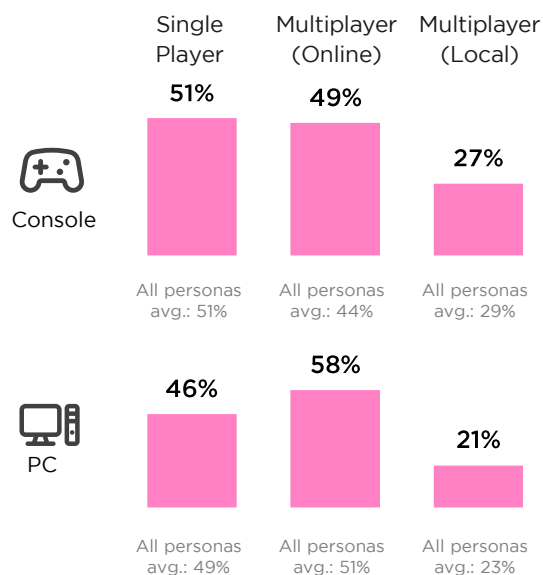
Story, Competing, Combat, Exploration, Role Playing, Thrills, Avatar

GAMER AFFINITY¹

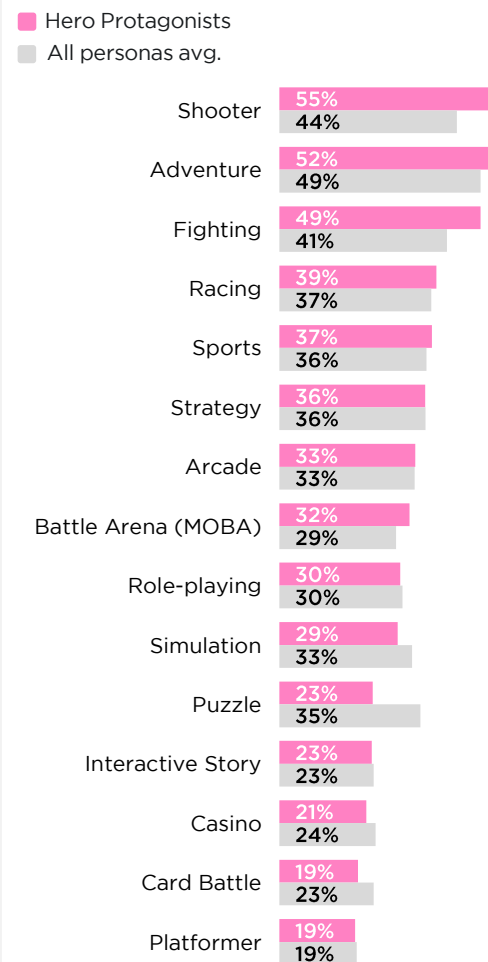


All personas avg.: L:17%, ML: 26%, HL: 30%, H: 28%

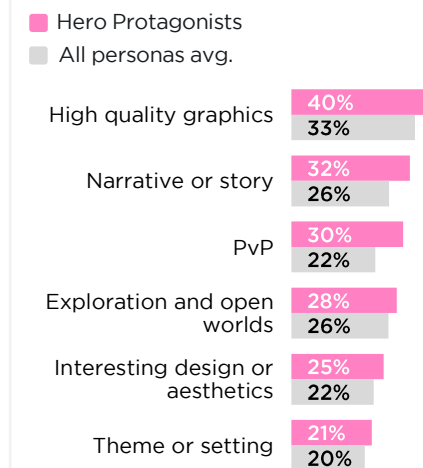
FAVORITE PC AND CONSOLE GAME MODES



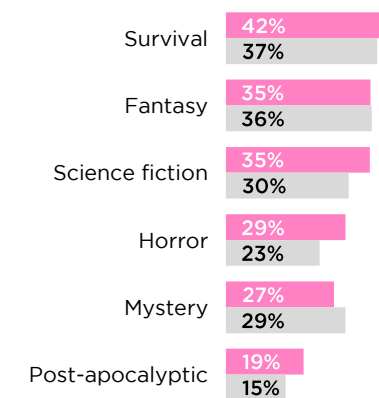
FAVORITE GENRES



MOST INTERESTING FEATURES



FAVORITE THEMES



Hero Protagonists: beyond playing



12%

Hero Protagonists

“Let me BE the story, lead the charge on missions, and change the world”

Hero Protagonists are quite a bit more likely to consider gaming to be their favorite pastime and view game-related video content. As a younger persona, it's no surprise that they can be found in higher-than-average numbers on TikTok.

MOST-REPRESENTED IN:

Colombia, Mexico, South Korea, South Africa, United States, Taiwan, United Arab Emirates, New Zealand, Argentina, Chile, Brazil

ENGAGEMENT BEYOND PLAY



View gaming content¹
78%



Engage other ways²
42%

All personas avg.: View: 76%, Other 40%

Very likely to explore other media related to favorite games **58%** Personas avg: 59%

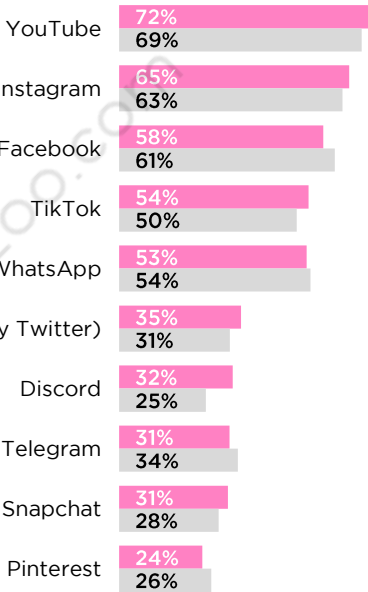
Say media/ merch' positively influences gameplay or purchase **54%** Personas avg: 55%

More likely to play a game featuring favorite entertainment brands **59%** Personas avg: 61%

Likely to pick up a game due to a TV show/movie from the franchise **61%** Personas avg: 60%

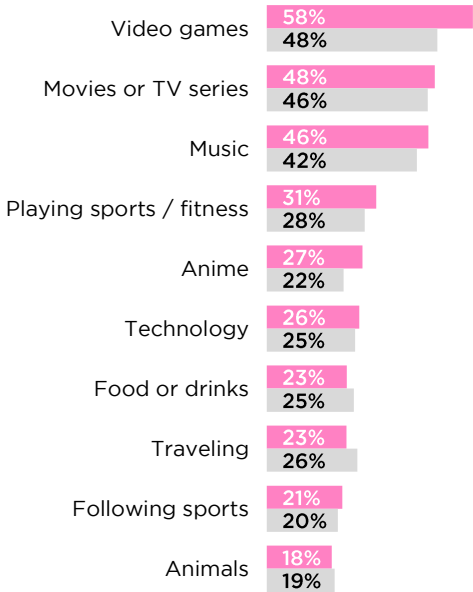
SOCIAL MEDIA USAGE

Hero Protagonists
All personas avg.



FAVORITE PASTIMES

Hero Protagonists
All personas avg.



PERSONA SIZE BY MARKET

US	CA	GB	DE	FR	ES	IT	NL	BE	SE	FI	PL	RU	TR	SA	AE	EG	ZA
14%	12%	12%	9%	10%	12%	12%	10%	10%	8%	8%	9%	12%	11%	9%	13%	6%	15%
CN	JP	KR	TW	ID	PH	VN	SG	TH	MY	IN	BR	MX	AR	CO	CL	AU	NZ
12%	9%	15%	13%	10%	12%	12%	12%	8%	12%	11%	13%	17%	13%	17%	13%	11%	13%



Open World Rangers

"I enjoy multiple challenges in vast worlds, often starting by setting up camp with others"

Open World Rangers enjoy nearly all genres, game features, and settings more than other gamers do. They show more interest in almost all motivations to play games, pointing to a desire to play a wide range of games with varied (and sometimes complex) mechanics. These gamers especially love survival themes, open world exploration, storytelling, and building, especially in multiplayer titles.

Open World Rangers are the youngest persona and they are also among the most comfortable when it comes to identifying as a gamer.

They enjoy longer play times and are often spenders who buy a broad range of in-game items. They are also the most likely persona to engage with gaming via viewing or discussing games with friends (online and in the real world) when compared to most personas, and are more active on social media, especially TikTok and Discord.

Open World Rangers: demographics, playing, and paying



11%

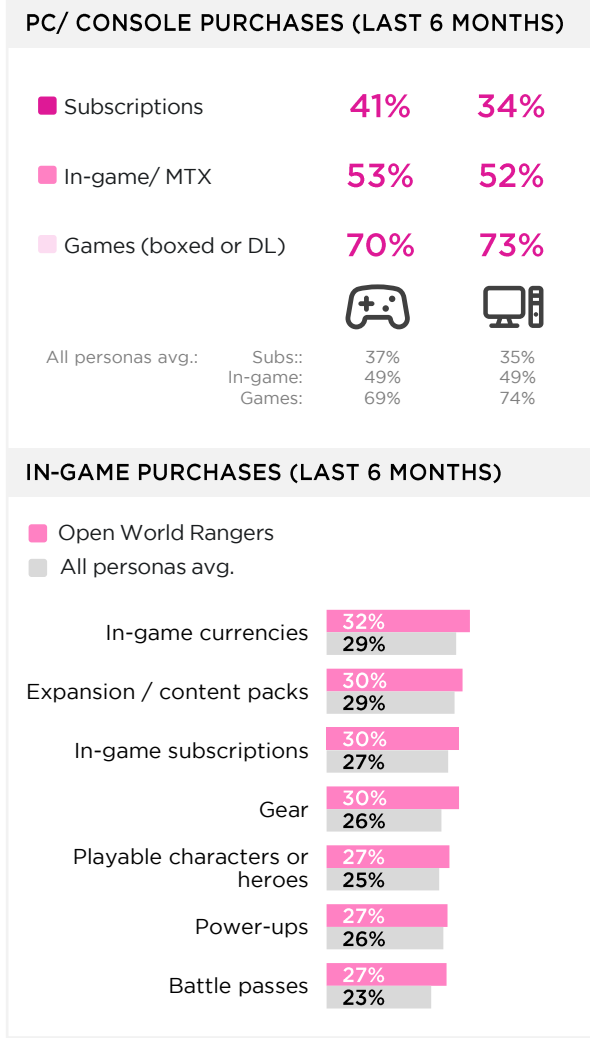
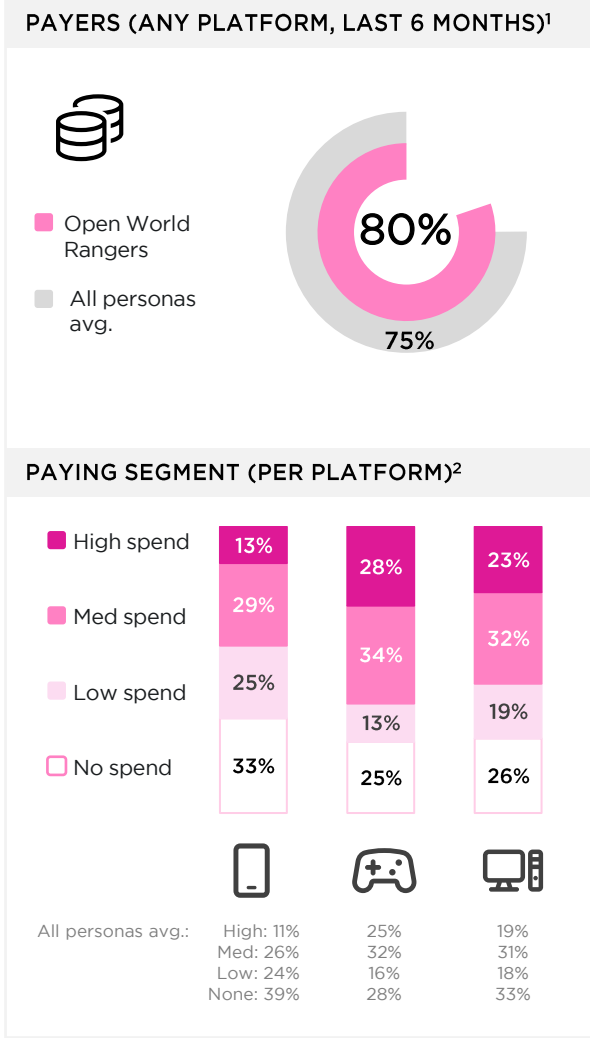
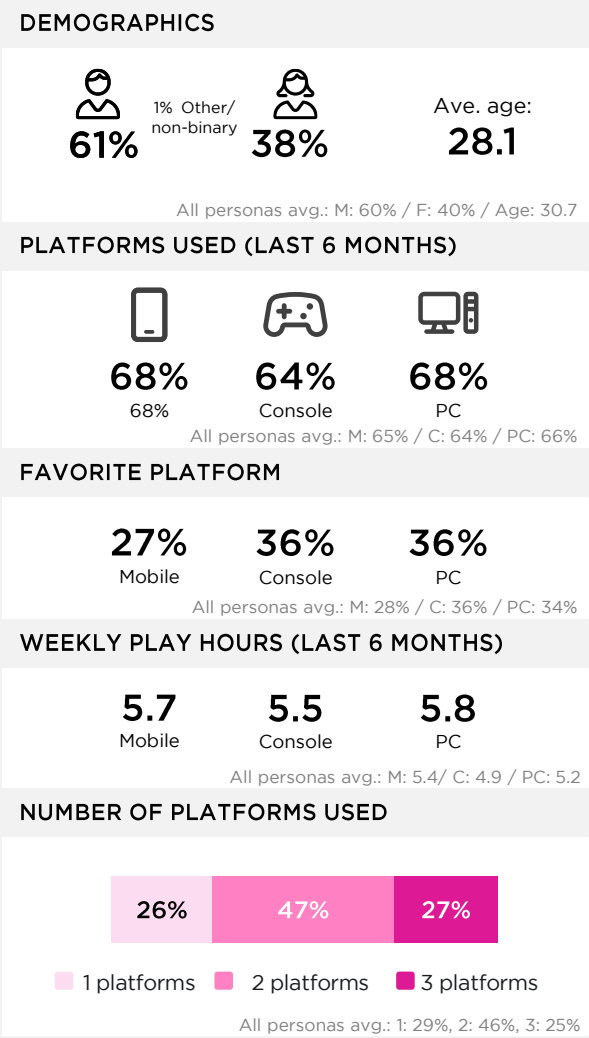
Open World Rangers

"I enjoy multiple challenges in vast worlds, often starting by setting up camp with others"

Open World Rangers are the youngest persona and are quite gender balanced. They have high play hours and are often spenders, especially for PC, where high and medium spenders almost match console. They also buy a wide range of in-game items.

CLOSE COUSINS (BY CROSSOVER):

- Hero Protagonists
- Planners & Tacticians
- Second Life Escapists



Open World Rangers: play preferences



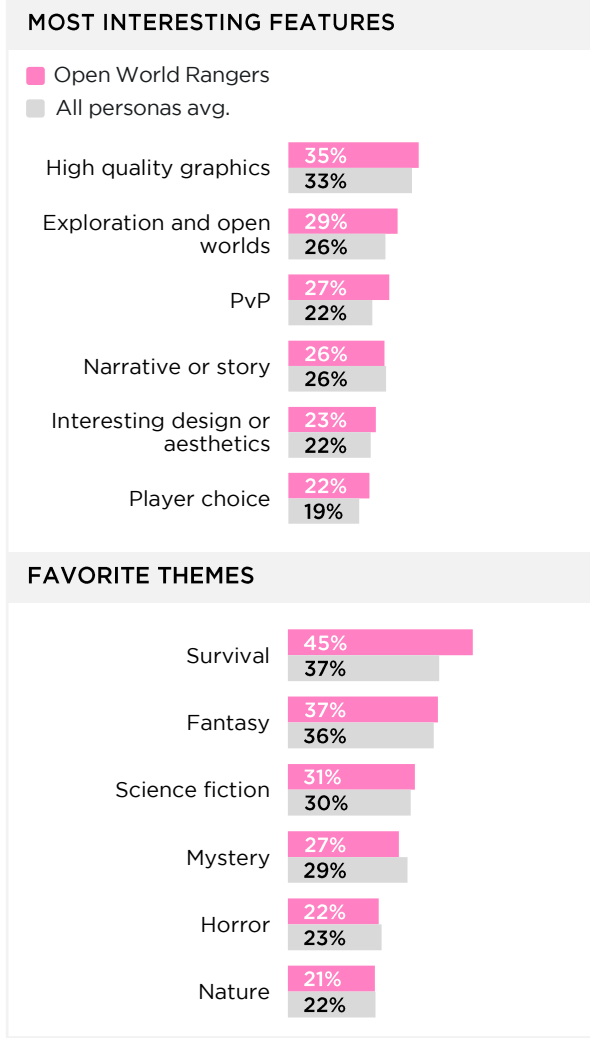
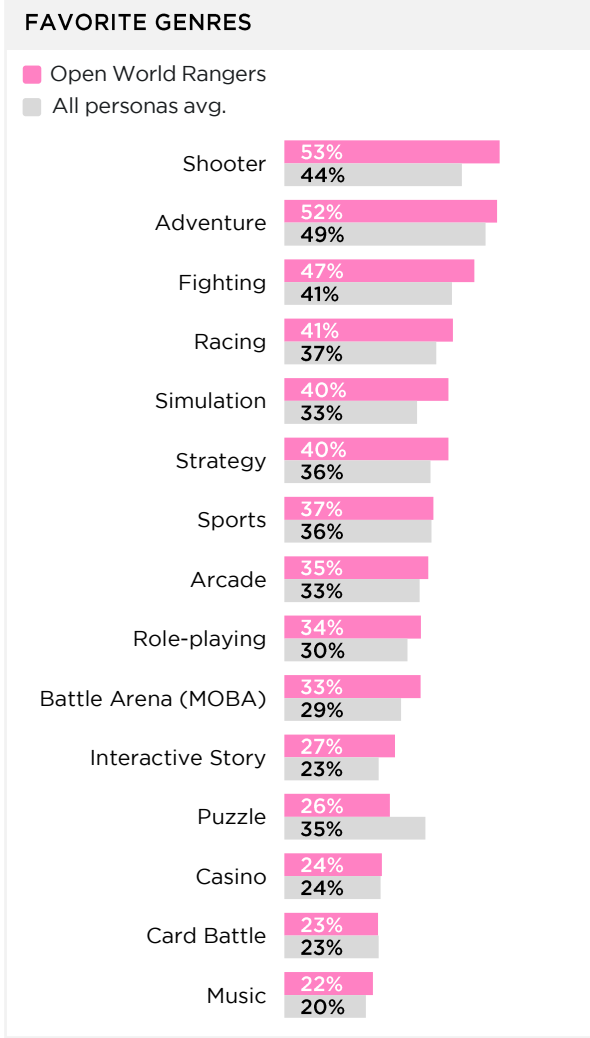
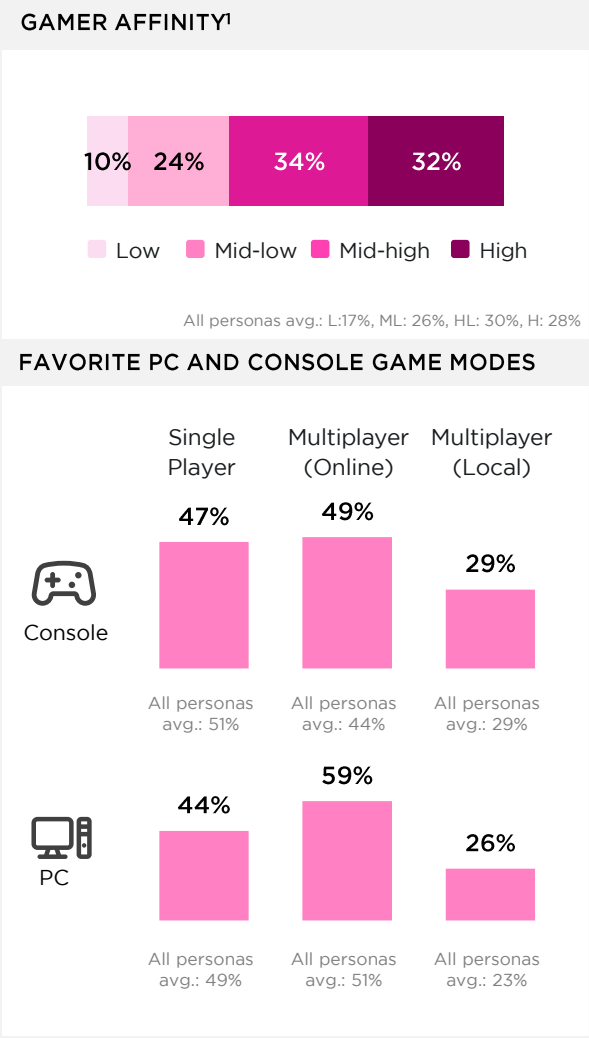
11%

Open World Rangers

"I enjoy multiple challenges in vast worlds, often starting by setting up camp with others"

Open World Rangers (and Competition Lovers) are the most likely multiplayers. They also have higher gamer affinity and appreciation for nearly all genres, features, and settings. They especially love Survival, and cite building, story, and exploring as top motivations.

TOP MOTIVATIONAL INPUTS:
Building, Story, Exploration, Avatar, Competing, Looting, Role Playing



Open World Rangers: beyond playing



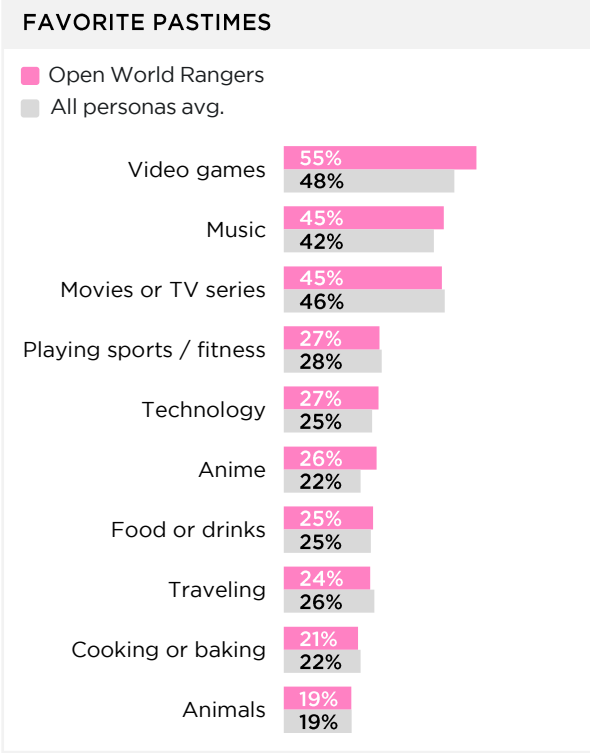
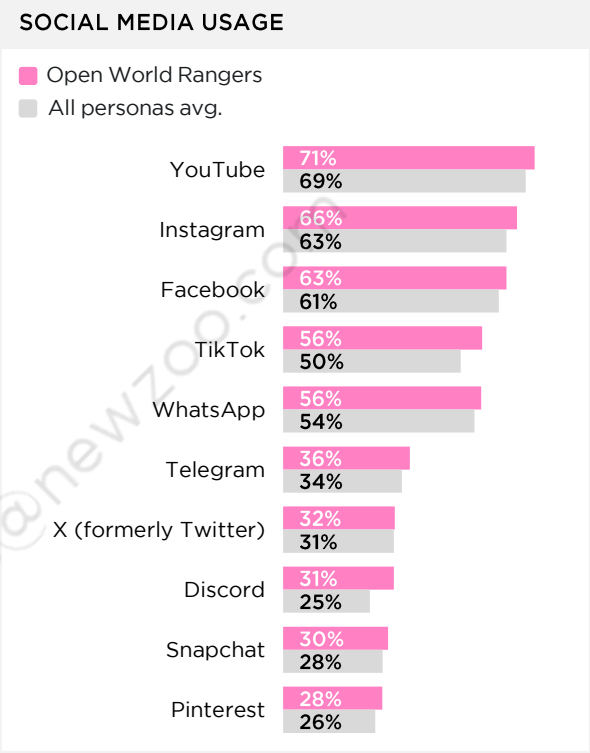
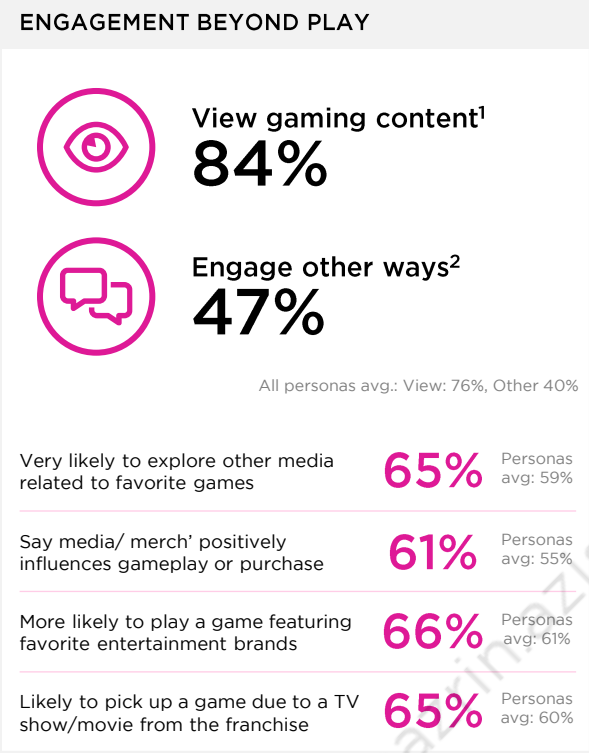
11%

Open World Rangers

"I enjoy multiple challenges in vast worlds, often starting by setting up camp with others"

Open World Rangers are the most likely persona to engage with gaming via viewing or in other ways. They are among the most positive about cross-media and brand collabs and are active on social media, especially TikTok and Discord.

MOST-REPRESENTED IN:
Vietnam, Argentina, Brazil, Chile, Colombia, Philippines, Türkiye, Mexico, South Korea



PERSONA SIZE BY MARKET																			
US	CA	GB	DE	FR	ES	IT	NL	BE	SE	FI	PL	RU	TR	SA	AE	EG	ZA		
12%	9%	10%	7%	8%	10%	6%	9%	10%	9%	7%	10%	10%	13%	10%	10%	8%	9%		
CN	JP	KR	TW	ID	PH	VN	SG	TH	MY	IN	BR	MX	AR	CO	CL	AU	NZ		
12%	6%	13%	12%	10%	14%	18%	12%	10%	12%	11%	15%	13%	15%	15%	15%	11%	11%		



Style-Conscious Party Players

"I'll play to compete, team up, chat, or hangout, and I want to look cool while I'm at it!"

Alongside combat and competition, **Style-Conscious Party Players** cite curating an avatar as a key reason to play games.

These players are among the most likely to buy relatively low-cost in-game items like power-ups, emotes, and cosmetics, and are likelier to say that PvP, PvE, and high replay value are appealing to them.

A relatively high preference for shooter, fighting, and MOBA games mirrors this mix, as does lower interest in storytelling and questing.

Style-Conscious Party Players are the second-youngest persona. As a young group, they are very likely to engage with gaming via viewing or in other ways outside of traditional play. They are also more positive than most about cross-media and brand collaborations.

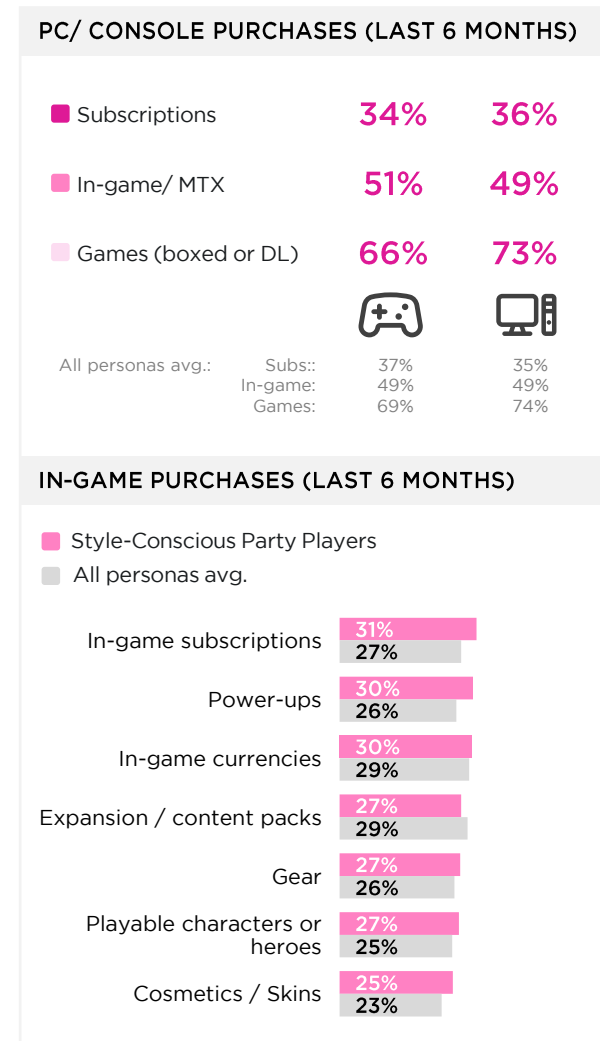
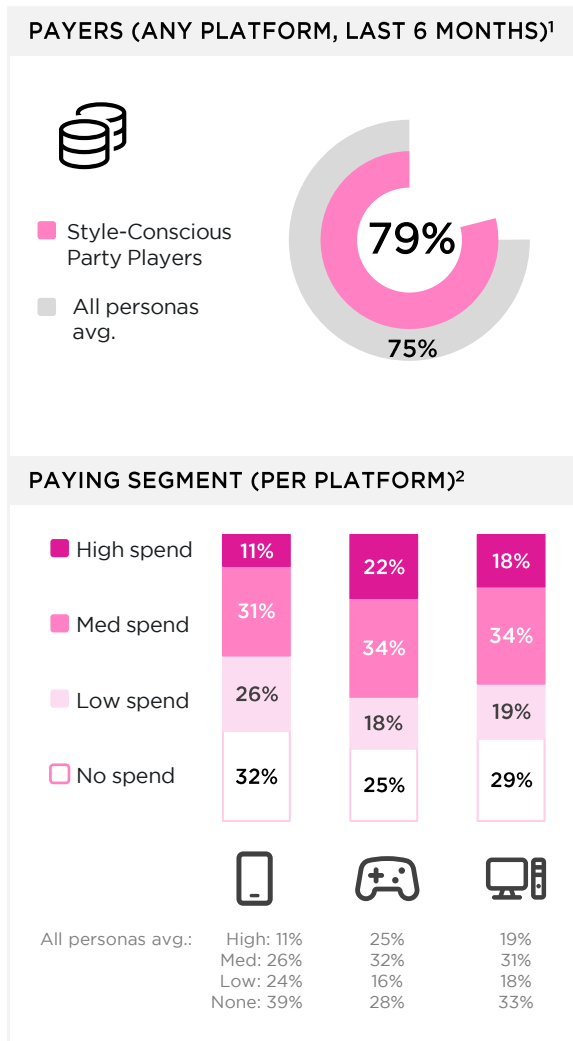
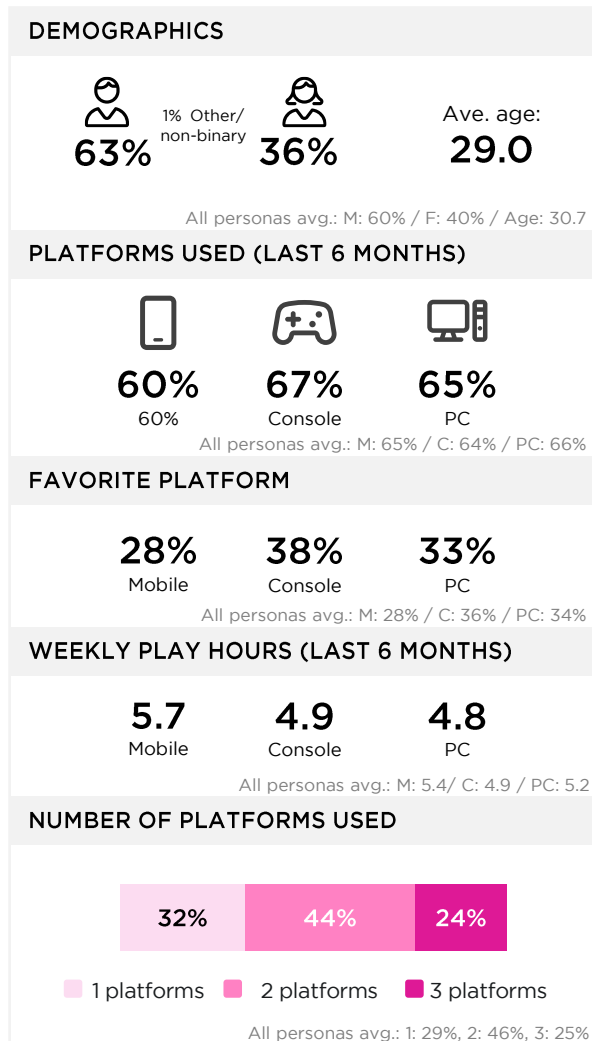
Style-Conscious Party Players: demographics, playing, and paying



Style-Conscious Party Players are the second-youngest persona after Open World Rangers. They are less likely to be payers and do not match the latter group's spending levels. That said, they do purchase a similarly wide range of in-game items.

CLOSE COUSINS (BY CROSSOVER):

Planners & Tacticians
Open World Rangers
Competition Lovers



Style-Conscious Party Players: play preferences



12%

Style-Conscious Party Players

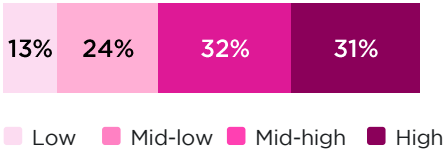
"I'll play to compete, team up, chat, or hangout, and I want to look cool while I'm at it!"

Style-Conscious Party Players identify styling their avatar as a key reason to play, as well as combat, competition, and co-op. A relatively high preference for fighting, Shooter, and MOBA mirrors this, as does a lower interest in story-telling and questing.

TOP MOTIVATIONAL INPUTS:

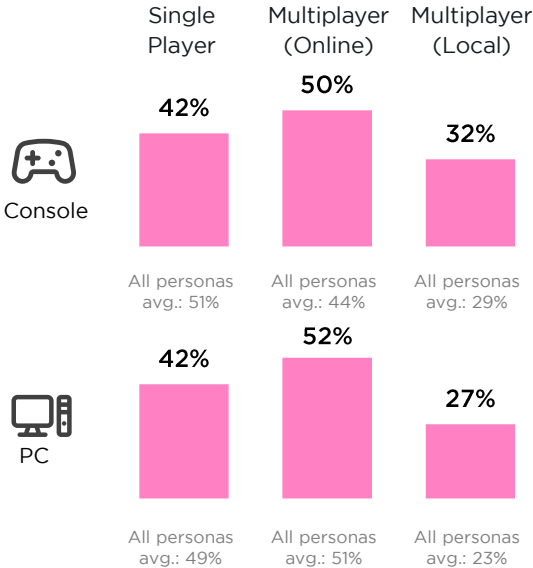
Combat, Avatar, Competing, Thrills, Exploration, Looting, Cooperation

GAMER AFFINITY¹



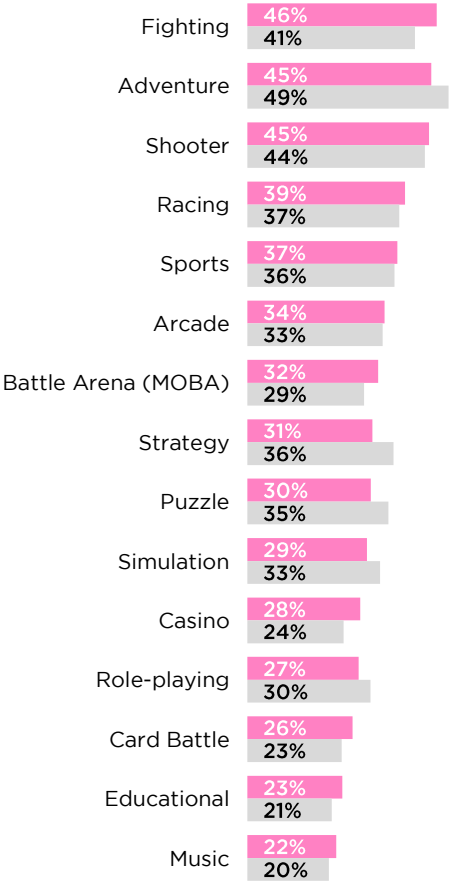
All personas avg.: L:17%, ML: 26%, HL: 30%, H: 28%

FAVORITE PC AND CONSOLE GAME MODES



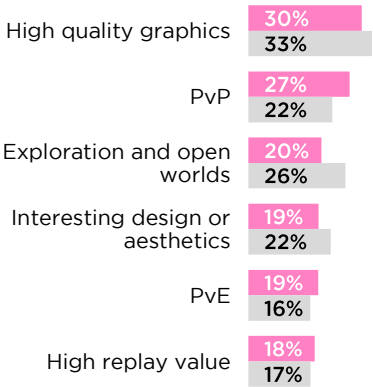
FAVORITE GENRES

Style-Conscious Party Players
All personas avg.

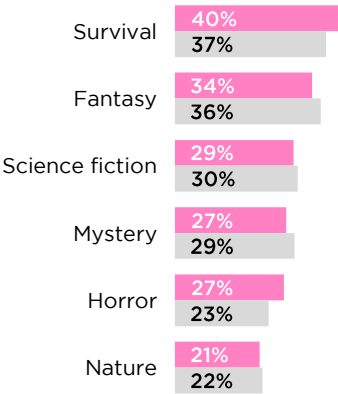


MOST INTERESTING FEATURES

Style-Conscious Party Players
All personas avg.



FAVORITE THEMES



Style-Conscious Party Players: beyond playing



12%

Style-Conscious Party Players

"I'll play to compete, team up, chat, or hangout, and I want to look cool while I'm at it!"

As a young group, Style-Conscious Party Players are very likely to engage with gaming via viewing or in other ways. They are also more positive than most about cross-media and brand collaborations.

MOST-REPRESENTED IN:

Thailand, Vietnam, China, New Zealand, United Arab Emirates, Canada, Singapore, United States, South Africa, Mexico, Saudi Arabia, Singapore

ENGAGEMENT BEYOND PLAY



View gaming content¹
82%



Engage other ways²
44%

All personas avg.: View: 76%, Other 40%

Very likely to explore other media related to favorite games **59%** Personas avg: 59%

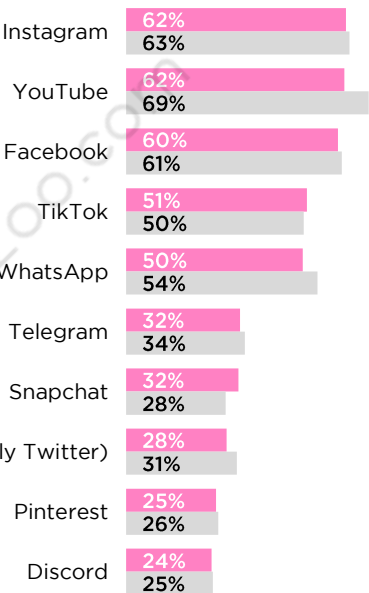
Say media/ merch' positively influences gameplay or purchase **59%** Personas avg: 55%

More likely to play a game featuring favorite entertainment brands **62%** Personas avg: 61%

Likely to pick up a game due to a TV show/movie from the franchise **60%** Personas avg: 60%

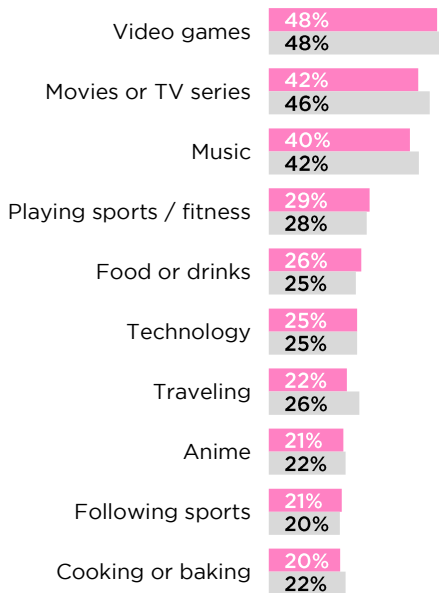
SOCIAL MEDIA USAGE

Style-Conscious Party Players
All personas avg.



FAVORITE PASTIMES

Style-Conscious Party Players
All personas avg.



PERSONA SIZE BY MARKET

US	CA	GB	DE	FR	ES	IT	NL	BE	SE	FI	PL	RU	TR	SA	AE	EG	ZA
13%	13%	13%	10%	11%	10%	10%	10%	11%	11%	12%	9%	4%	11%	13%	14%	8%	13%
CN	JP	KR	TW	ID	PH	VN	SG	TH	MY	IN	BR	MX	AR	CO	CL	AU	NZ
15%	8%	10%	11%	13%	12%	15%	13%	16%	11%	13%	11%	13%	11%	11%	11%	11%	14%



Competition Lovers

"I'm happiest when I'm facing off against other people!"

Competition Lovers are more motivated by (player versus player) PvP than other Personas, and love games involving combat, chaos, and thrills. However, they show average or lower interest in other reasons to play, which marks them out as quite single-minded in their gaming needs.

They play multiplayer more than most and lean toward genres where they can play against others, such as shooters, sports, racing, and fighting games. As well as PvP, they are also drawn with survival theme and high-quality graphics as mechanic.

Competition Lovers are a large, very male-skewed, group of PC and console players who play more hours on average than most other personas and are quite likely to pay for gaming, especially on gear and battle passes.

They are slightly more likely to use almost all major social media platforms. As well as games, they particularly enjoy playing or following sports as a pastime.

Competition Lovers: demographics, playing, and paying



14%

Competition Lovers

"I'm happiest when I'm facing off against other people!"

Competition Lovers are a large, very male-skewed, group of PC and console players. They score slightly higher for weekly play hours and paying in general, especially for gear and battle passes.

CLOSE COUSINS (BY CROSSOVER):

- Planners & Tacticians
- Hero Protagonists
- Builders, Farmers, & Nurturers

DEMOGRAPHICS



76%

0% Other/
non-binary



24%

Ave. age:
30.6

All personas avg.: M: 60% / F: 40% / Age: 30.7

PLATFORMS USED (LAST 6 MONTHS)



66%



65%

66%



66%

66%

All personas avg.: M: 65% / C: 64% / PC: 66%

FAVORITE PLATFORM

25%

Mobile

37%

Console

37%

PC

All personas avg.: M: 28% / C: 36% / PC: 34%

WEEKLY PLAY HOURS (LAST 6 MONTHS)

5.4

Mobile

5.0

Console

5.4

PC

All personas avg.: M: 5.4/ C: 4.9 / PC: 5.2

NUMBER OF PLATFORMS USED

28%

46%

25%

1 platforms

2 platforms

3 platforms

All personas avg.: 1: 29%, 2: 46%, 3: 25%

PAYERS (ANY PLATFORM, LAST 6 MONTHS)¹



Competition Lovers

75%

All personas avg.

75%

PAYING SEGMENT (PER PLATFORM)²

High spend

10%

24%

18%

Med spend

24%

31%

30%

Low spend

24%

16%

19%

No spend

42%

29%

33%

All personas avg.:

High: 11%

Med: 26%

Low: 24%

None: 39%

25%

32%

16%

28%

19%

31%

18%

33%







PC/ CONSOLE PURCHASES (LAST 6 MONTHS)

Subscriptions

36%

33%

In-game/ MTX

48%

50%

Games (boxed or DL)

69%

71%

All personas avg.:

Subs: 37%

In-game: 49%

Games: 69%





35%

49%

74%

IN-GAME PURCHASES (LAST 6 MONTHS)

Competition Lovers

All personas avg.

In-game currencies

29%

29%

Gear

29%

26%

In-game subscriptions

27%

27%

Expansion / content packs

27%

29%

Battle passes

26%

23%

Removal of ads

25%

24%

Playable characters or heroes

25%

25%

newzoo

Source: Newzoo Global Gamer Study 2025 (Global weighted average across 36 markets)
Base: Playing on PC or Console (n= 39,035), Competition Lovers (n=5,968)

¹ Players who spend money on average monthly, on games on a PC, console, or mobile device. Spending money includes gifts, downloadable content, subscriptions, and other micro-transactions
² Minor spend: up to £/€/\$5 a month; Average spend: between £/€/\$5 – £/€/\$25 a month; Big spend: £/€/\$25 or more a month

39

Competition Lovers: play preferences



14%

Competition Lovers

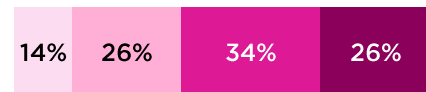
"I'm happiest when I'm facing off against other people!"

Competition Lovers play multiplayer more than most, and over-index for playing Shooters, Sports, Racing, and Fighting games, among others. They want to hear about graphics, PvP, and PvE, especially in a survival or sci-fi setting.

TOP MOTIVATIONAL INPUTS:

Competing, Combat, Thrills, Strategy, Exploration, Story, Cooperation

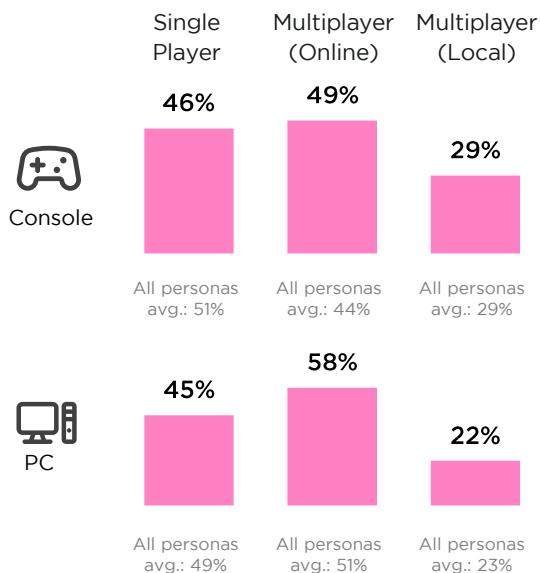
GAMER AFFINITY¹



Low Mid-low Mid-high High

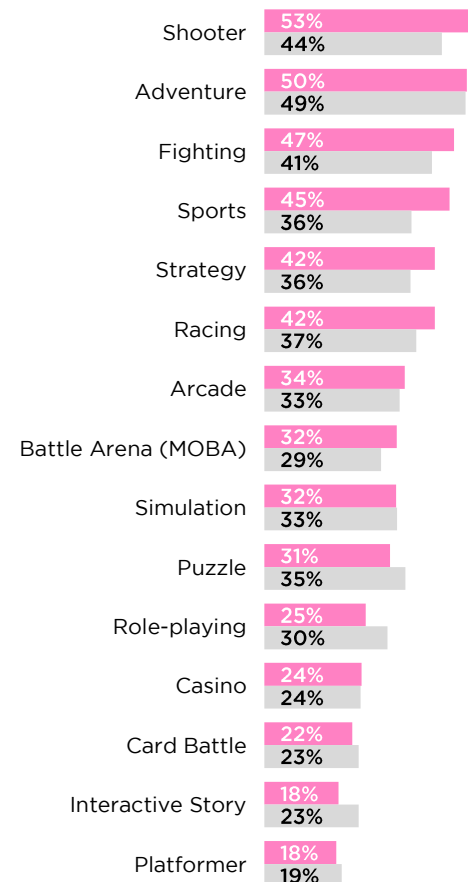
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FAVORITE PC AND CONSOLE GAME MODES



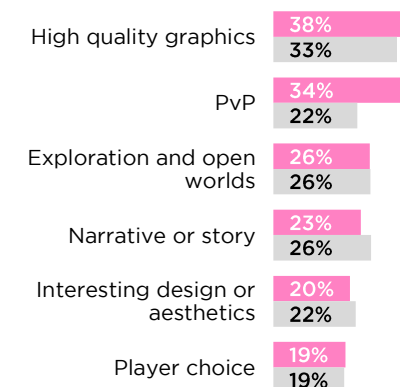
FAVORITE GENRES

Competition Lovers
All personas avg.

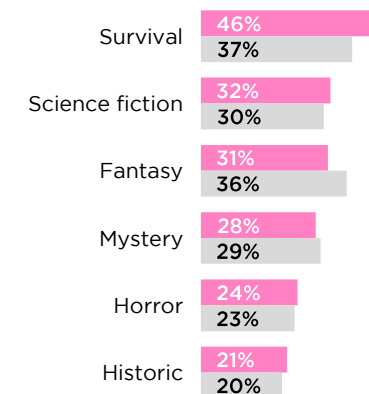


MOST INTERESTING FEATURES

Competition Lovers
All personas avg.



FAVORITE THEMES



Competition Lovers: beyond playing



14%

Competition Lovers

"I'm happiest when I'm facing off against other people!"

Competition Lovers are slightly more likely to use almost all major social media platforms. As well as games, they particularly enjoy playing or following sports, and are interested in technology as a pastime.

MOST-REPRESENTED IN:

Egypt, Argentina, Russia, Netherlands, Colombia, Italy, Thailand, Chile, Saudi Arabia, Mexico, Malaysia, Belgium

ENGAGEMENT BEYOND PLAY



View gaming content¹
77%



Engage other ways²
40%

All personas avg.: View: 76%, Other 40%

Very likely to explore other media related to favorite games **59%** Personas avg: 59%

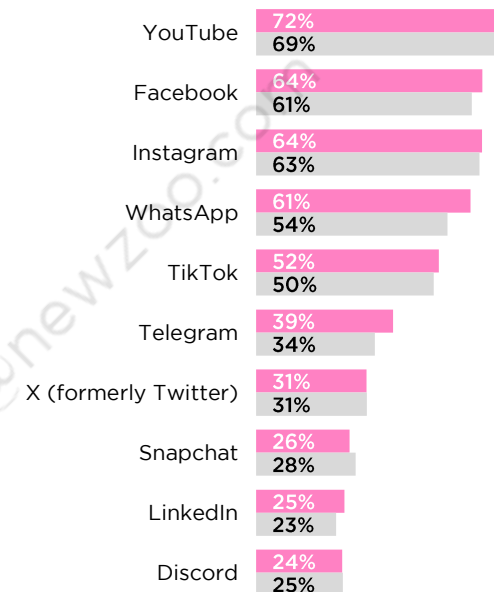
Say media/ merch' positively influences gameplay or purchase **56%** Personas avg: 55%

More likely to play a game featuring favorite entertainment brands **60%** Personas avg: 61%

Likely to pick up a game due to a TV show/movie from the franchise **62%** Personas avg: 60%

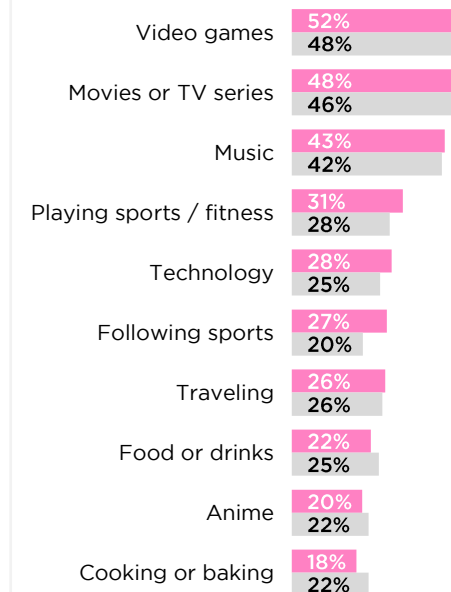
SOCIAL MEDIA USAGE

Competition Lovers
All personas avg.



FAVORITE PASTIMES

Competition Lovers
All personas avg.



PERSONA SIZE BY MARKET

US	CA	GB	DE	FR	ES	IT	NL	BE	SE	FI	PL	RU	TR	SA	AE	EG	ZA
11%	13%	12%	14%	14%	16%	20%	20%	18%	16%	13%	13%	22%	16%	18%	16%	25%	17%
CN	JP	KR	TW	ID	PH	VN	SG	TH	MY	IN	BR	MX	AR	CO	CL	AU	NZ
9%	6%	17%	10%	11%	13%	10%	13%	19%	18%	12%	17%	18%	22%	20%	19%	13%	12%



Planners & Tacticians

“I prepare and plan, but also have the skills to help me adapt when necessary”

Planners & Tacticians combine thinking ahead with an ability to quickly adapt, based on a deep and detailed understanding of the games they play. They enjoy more genres than the average player does, but they particularly love strategy, MOBA, card battlers, fighting, sports, and racing games.

Planners & Tacticians seem the most comfortable of all personas with the gamer label: they are among the likeliest to play on all three platforms, watch gaming content when they are not playing, and engage with gaming through communities, discussions with friends, or on other social networks.

This group also has a higher number of PC and mobile spenders. These gamers are likelier to make in-game purchases of all types, but especially those that can meaningfully support gameplay, like power-ups, gear and time savers.

Planners & Tacticians: demographics, playing, and paying

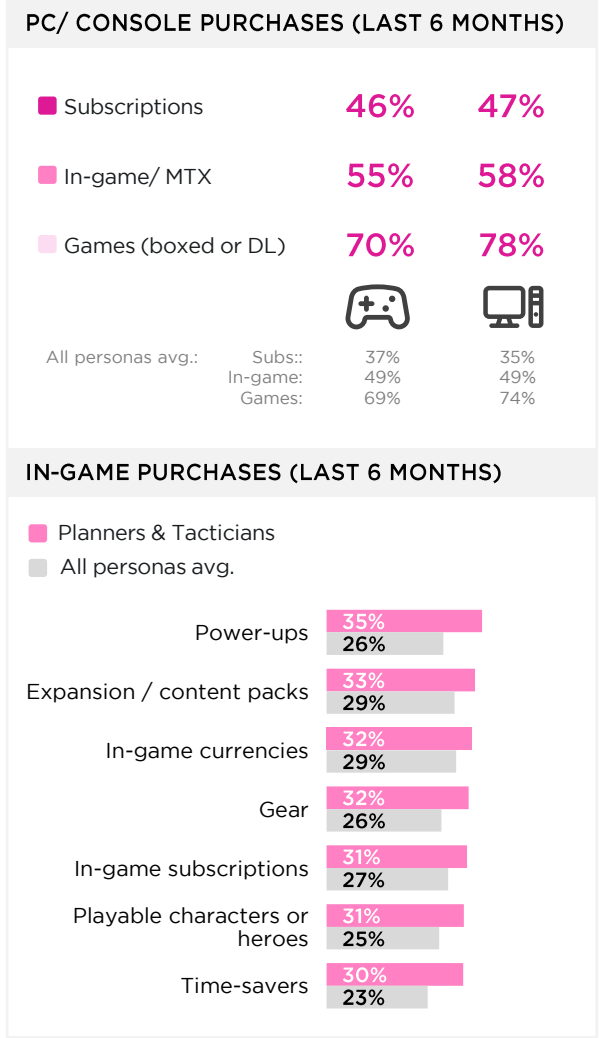
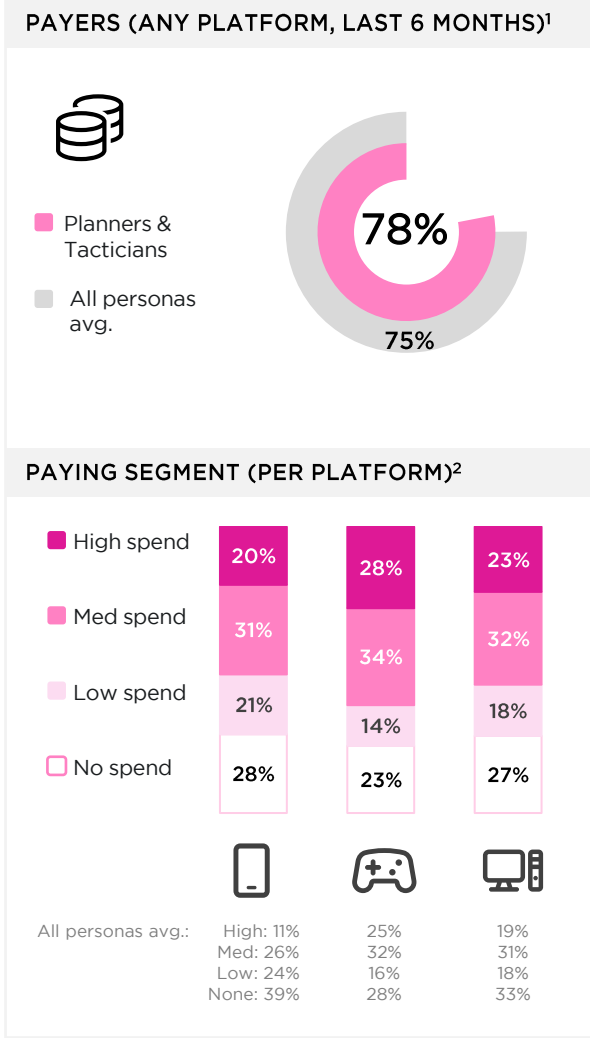
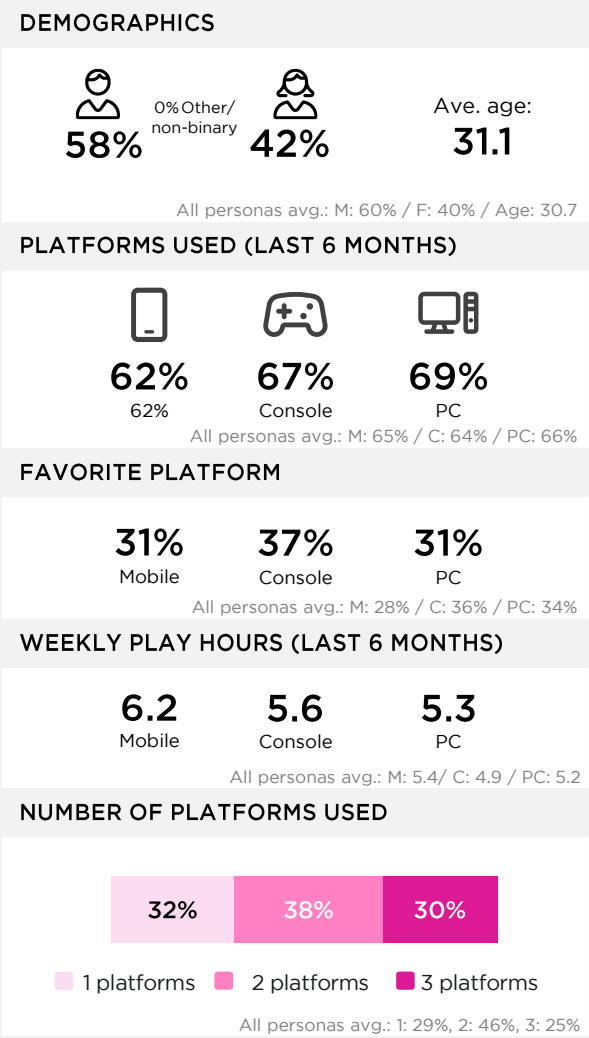


Planners & Tacticians

"I prepare and plan, but also have the skills to help me adapt when necessary"

Planners & Tacticians are younger players who are likelier than most to use PC, even though they favor console. They are more likely to pay and have higher numbers of PC and mobile spenders than the average.

- CLOSE COUSINS (BY CROSSOVER):
- Style-Conscious Party Players
 - Open World Rangers
 - Puzzlers & Personal Besters



Planners & Tacticians: play preferences



13%

Planners & Tacticians

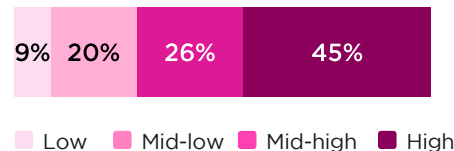
"I prepare and plan, but also have the skills to help me adapt when necessary"

Planners & Tacticians have the highest gamer affinity score of all personas, and favor nearly all genres more than others do (especially Fighting, Shooters, Racing, Sports, MOBA, Arcade, and Card Battlers). They also prefer PC multiplayer to console.

TOP MOTIVATIONAL INPUTS:

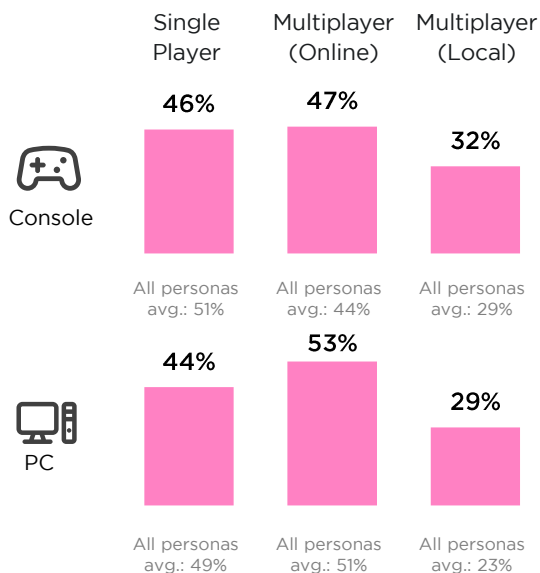
Strategy, Puzzle, Avatar, Competing, Story, Combat, Thrills

GAMER AFFINITY¹



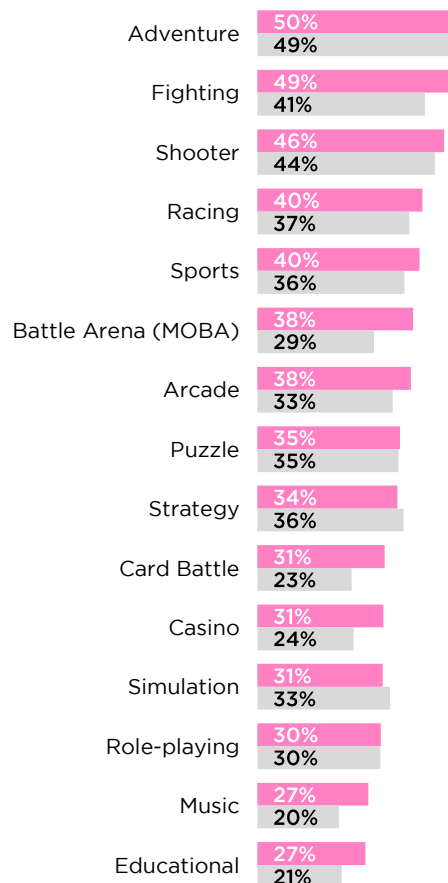
All personas avg.: L:17%, ML: 26%, HL: 30%, H: 28%

FAVORITE PC AND CONSOLE GAME MODES



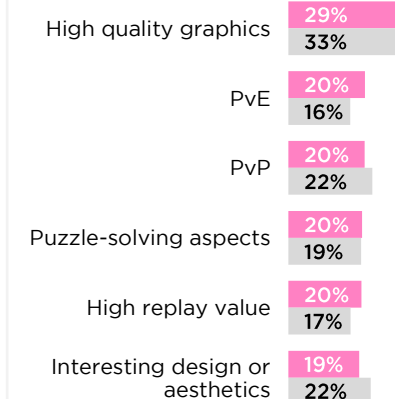
FAVORITE GENRES

Planners & Tacticians
All personas avg.

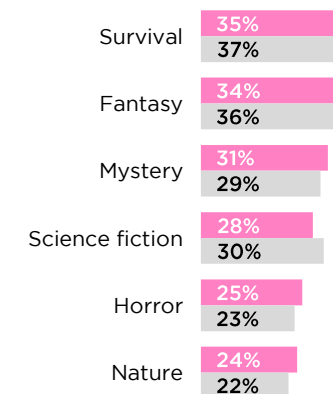


MOST INTERESTING FEATURES

Planners & Tacticians
All personas avg.



FAVORITE THEMES



Planners & Tacticians: beyond playing



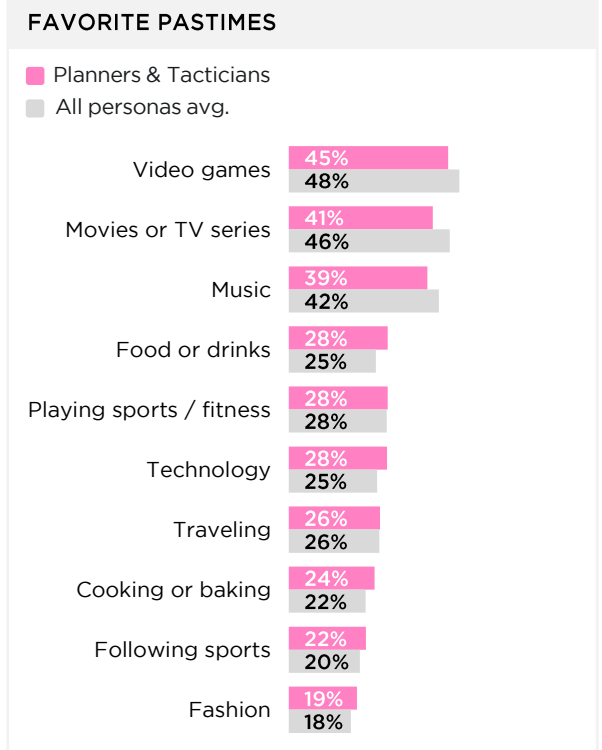
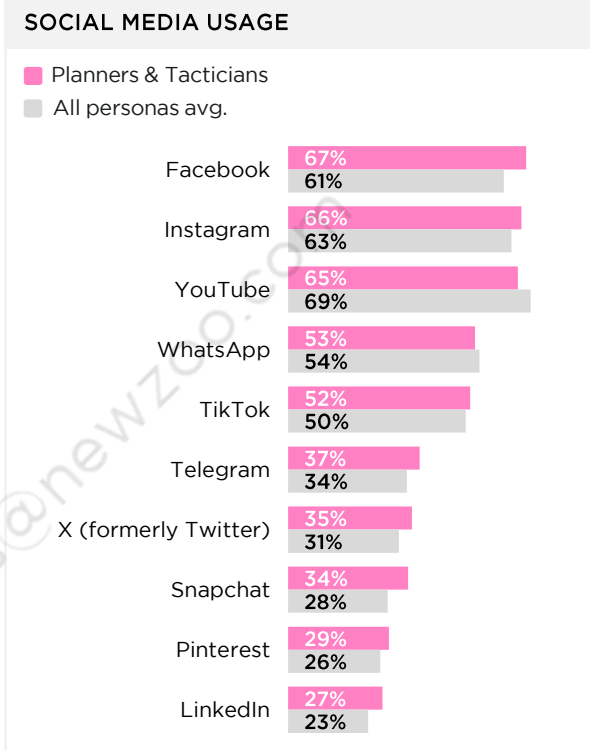
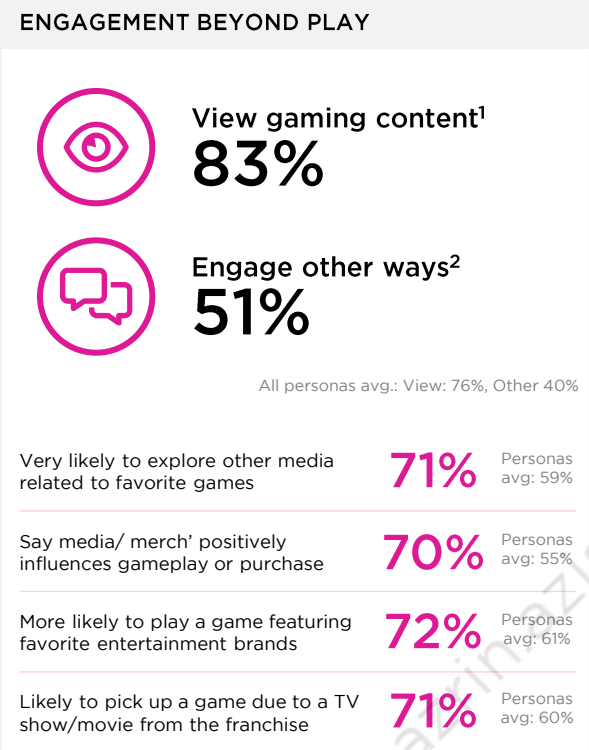
13%

Planners & Tacticians

"I prepare and plan, but also have the skills to help me adapt when necessary"

Along with Style-Conscious Party Players, Planners & Tacticians are among the likeliest to engage with gaming via viewing or in other ways and are the most positive regarding cross-media and brand collaborations.

MOST-REPRESENTED IN:
Indonesia, Thailand, India, United States, China, United Arab Emirates, Vietnam, Saudi Arabia, Philippines, Malaysia, United Kingdom



PERSONA SIZE BY MARKET

US	CA	GB	DE	FR	ES	IT	NL	BE	SE	FI	PL	RU	TR	SA	AE	EG	ZA
16%	10%	14%	9%	10%	8%	9%	10%	10%	9%	7%	9%	5%	13%	15%	16%	9%	12%
CN	JP	KR	TW	ID	PH	VN	SG	TH	MY	IN	BR	MX	AR	CO	CL	AU	NZ
16%	11%	11%	10%	24%	15%	16%	13%	18%	14%	18%	13%	9%	8%	9%	10%	12%	11%



Builders, Farmers, & Nurturers

“I love building things, and
then growing them or looking
after them”

Builders, Farmers, & Nurturers enjoy natural or historic settings where they can create, harvest, manage, and grow things. They prefer solo play, and place puzzle and strategy higher in their list of favored genres than other personas do.

With many suggesting they have low or medium-low affinity with the idea of being a gamer, they seem to be quite a casual group at first glance: They register some of the lowest weekly PC and console play hours, are a lot less likely to pay for their games and are the least likely of to engage with gaming via viewing or other means.

However, segmenting the group by platform shows that Builders, Farmers, & Nurturers who prefer PC or console over mobile are nearly twice as likely to align with the idea that they are a gamer, suggesting the group has a small but noteworthy “core” player subpopulation.

Builders, Farmers, & Nurturers: demographics, playing, and paying



6%

Builders, Farmers, & Nurturers

"I love building things, and then growing them or looking after them"

Builders, Farmers, & Nurturers are less likely to play on console but just as likely to play on PC or mobile as the other personas. They are a lot less likely to pay for their games, make in-game purchases, or have subscriptions.

CLOSE COUSINS (BY CROSSOVER):

Solo Adventurers
Puzzlers & Personal Besters
Competition Lovers

DEMOGRAPHICS



All personas avg.: M: 60% / F: 40% / Age: 30.7

PLATFORMS USED (LAST 6 MONTHS)



All personas avg.: M: 65% / C: 64% / PC: 66%

FAVORITE PLATFORM



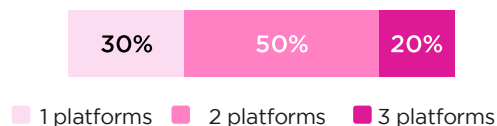
All personas avg.: M: 28% / C: 36% / PC: 34%

WEEKLY PLAY HOURS (LAST 6 MONTHS)



All personas avg.: M: 5.4/ C: 4.9 / PC: 5.2

NUMBER OF PLATFORMS USED



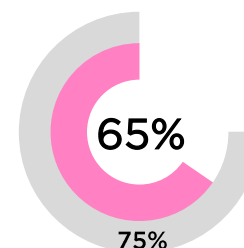
All personas avg.: 1: 29%, 2: 46%, 3: 25%

PAYERS (ANY PLATFORM, LAST 6 MONTHS)¹

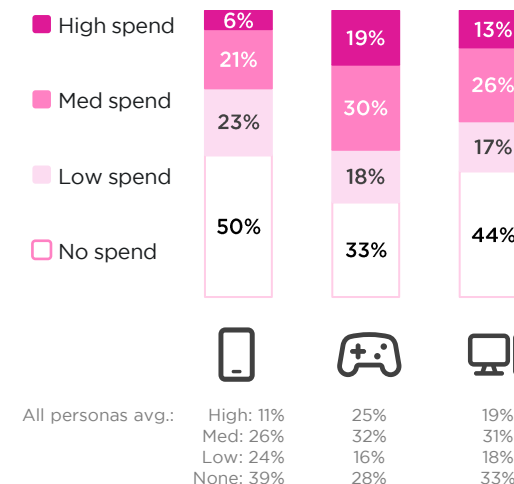


Builders, Farmers, & Nurtures

All personas avg.

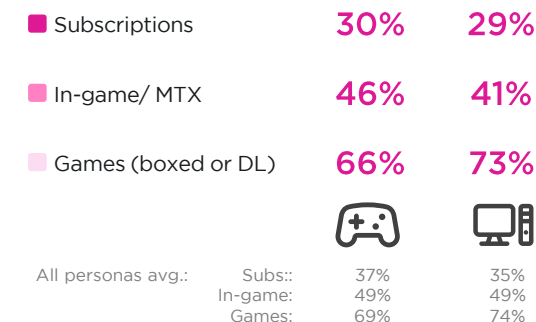


PAYING SEGMENT (PER PLATFORM)²

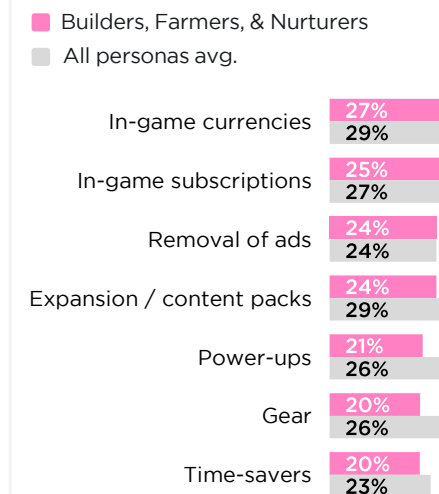


All personas avg.: High: 11% 25% 19%
Med: 26% 32% 31%
Low: 24% 16% 18%
None: 39% 28% 33%

PC/ CONSOLE PURCHASES (LAST 6 MONTHS)



IN-GAME PURCHASES (LAST 6 MONTHS)



Builders, Farmers, & Nurturers: play preferences



6%

Builders, Farmers, & Nurturers

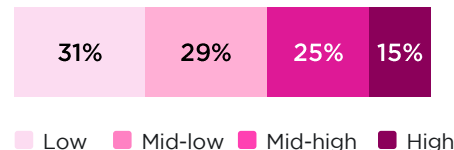
"I love building things, and then growing them or looking after them"

Builders, Farmers, & Nurturers like building, puzzles, and loot. Preferring solo play, they place puzzle and strategy games higher in their genre lists than other personas do. This also applies to harvesting and collecting, and natural or historic game settings.

TOP MOTIVATIONAL INPUTS:

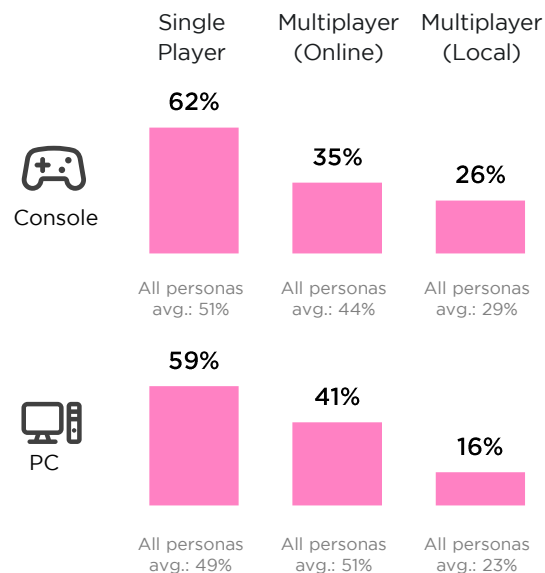
Building, Puzzle, Looting, Strategy, Completion, Exploration, Story

GAMER AFFINITY¹

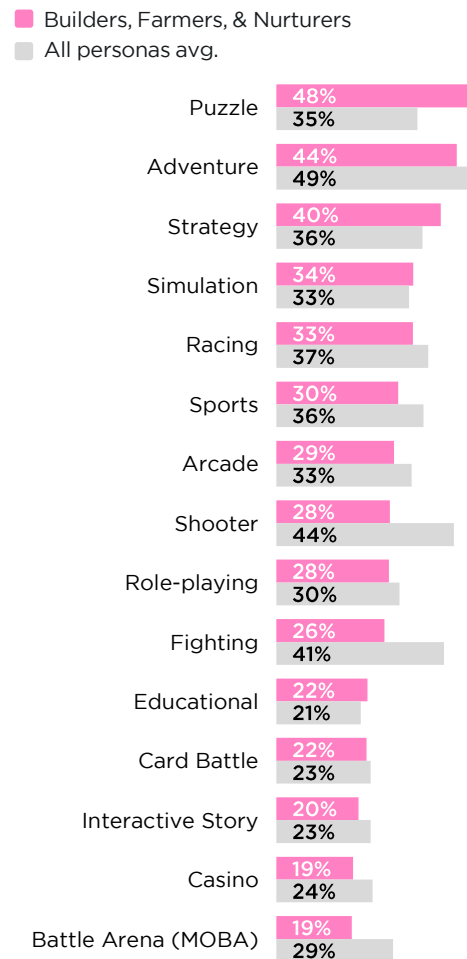


All personas avg.: L:17%, ML: 26%, HL: 30%, H: 28%

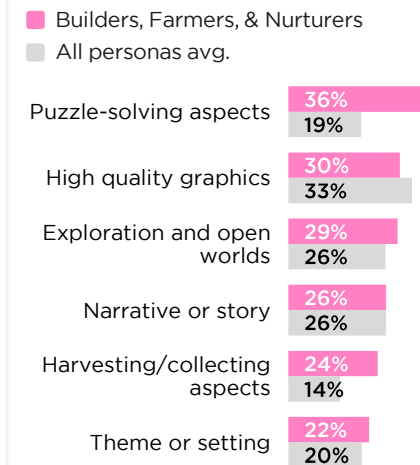
FAVORITE PC AND CONSOLE GAME MODES



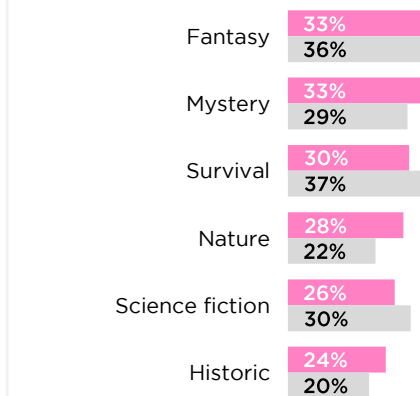
FAVORITE GENRES



MOST INTERESTING FEATURES



FAVORITE THEMES



Builders, Farmers, & Nurturers: beyond playing



6%

Builders, Farmers, & Nurturers

"I love building things, and then growing them or looking after them"

Builders, Farmers, & Nurturers are less likely than all other groups to engage with gaming via viewing or other means. This is mirrored in their favorite pastimes, where gaming is ranked lower than movies, TV, or music.

MOST-REPRESENTED IN:

Germany, Sweden, Netherlands, Finland, Russia, Spain, Poland, Japan, Egypt, Australia

ENGAGEMENT BEYOND PLAY



View gaming content¹

63%



Engage other ways²

31%

All personas avg.: View: 76%, Other 40%

Very likely to explore other media related to favorite games

48%

Personas avg: 59%

Say media/ merch' positively influences gameplay or purchase

43%

Personas avg: 55%

More likely to play a game featuring favorite entertainment brands

50%

Personas avg: 61%

Likely to pick up a game due to a TV show/movie from the franchise

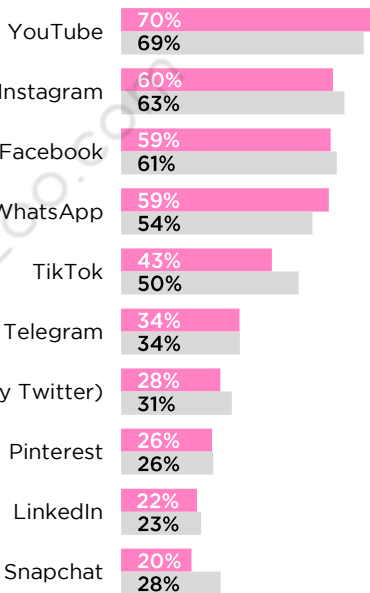
51%

Personas avg: 60%

SOCIAL MEDIA USAGE

Builders, Farmers, & Nurturers

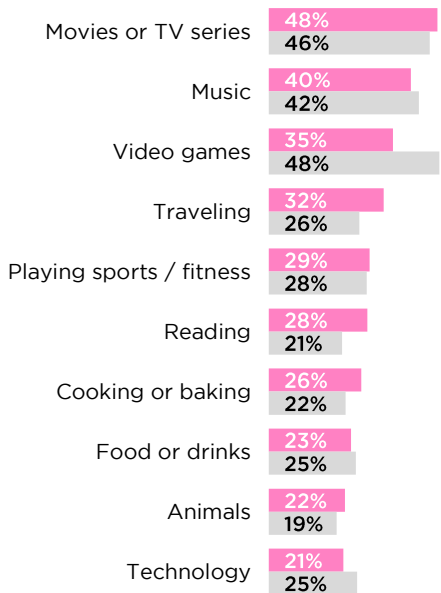
All personas avg.



FAVORITE PASTIMES

Builders, Farmers, & Nurturers

All personas avg.



PERSONA SIZE BY MARKET

US	CA	GB	DE	FR	ES	IT	NL	BE	SE	FI	PL	RU	TR	SA	AE	EG	ZA
4%	7%	6%	12%	7%	9%	7%	10%	7%	11%	10%	8%	9%	7%	6%	7%	8%	6%
CN	JP	KR	TW	ID	PH	VN	SG	TH	MY	IN	BR	MX	AR	CO	CL	AU	NZ
5%	8%	6%	7%	6%	5%	4%	6%	6%	6%	5%	6%	3%	5%	5%	5%	8%	7%



Second Life Escapists

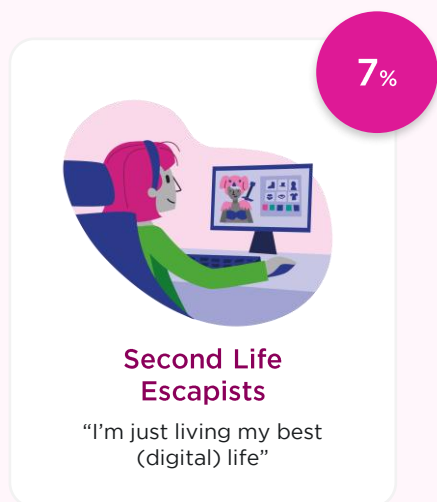
"I'm just living my best (digital) life"

Second Life Escapists prefer single player games where they can lose themselves in a digital world, curate and style an avatar, and engage in a (usually non-threatening) story via role playing. They appreciate interesting design, exploration, and lots of player choice, and like to play simulation, puzzle, RPGs, and interactive stories, especially if they have a fantasy, mystery, or natural world theme.

Second Life Escapists have the biggest female cohort by far and are more often than not casual gamers. They slightly prefer mobile devices and are less likely to pay for their games or follow gaming content beyond playing.

They prefer music, movies, and TV over video games as a pastime, and generally have a wider range of hobbies than other gamers do. They are particularly likely to list reading, travelling, fashion, animals and pets, and cooking or baking, as things they do outside of gaming.

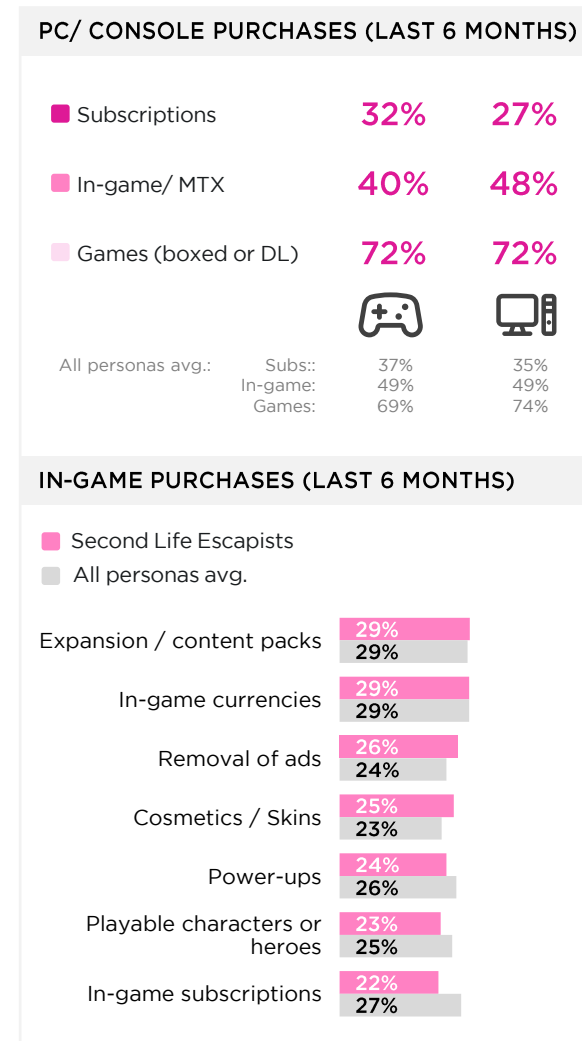
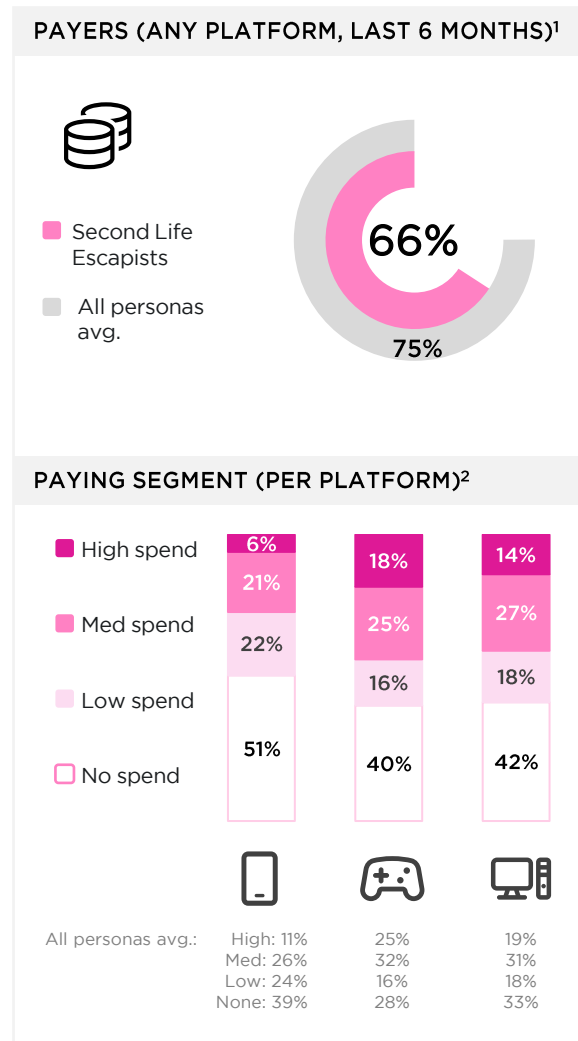
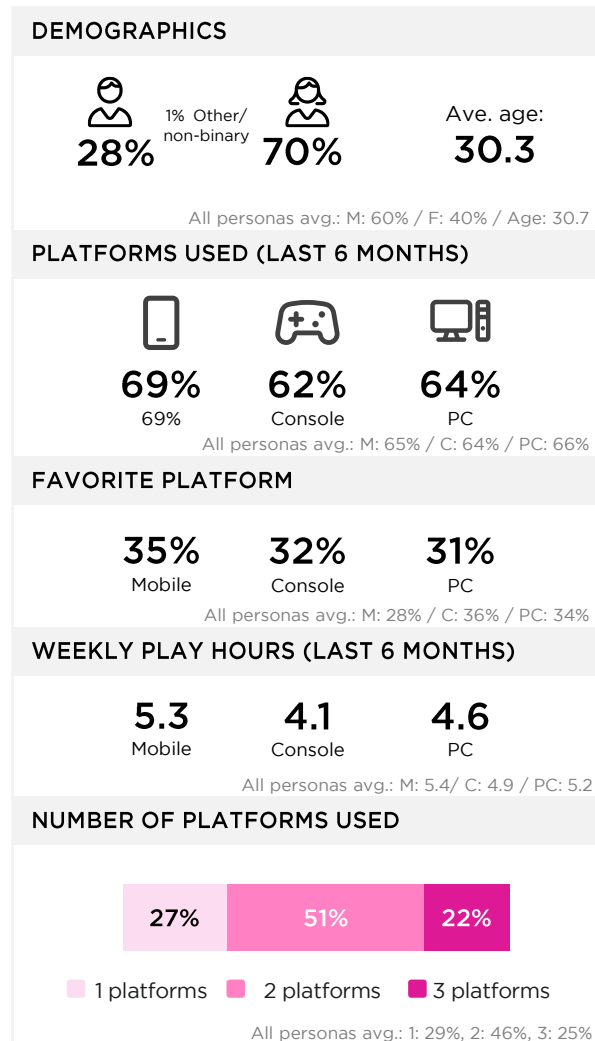
Second Life Escapists: demographics, playing, and paying



Second Life Escapists have the biggest female cohort. Like Builders, Farmers, & Nurturers, they are less likely to play on console, but equally likely to play PC or mobile, spending more time on the latter. They are also similarly unlikely to be payers.

CLOSE COUSINS (BY CROSSOVER):

Solo Adventurers
Builders, Farmers, & Nurturers
Puzzlers & Personal Besters



Second Life Escapists: play preferences



7%

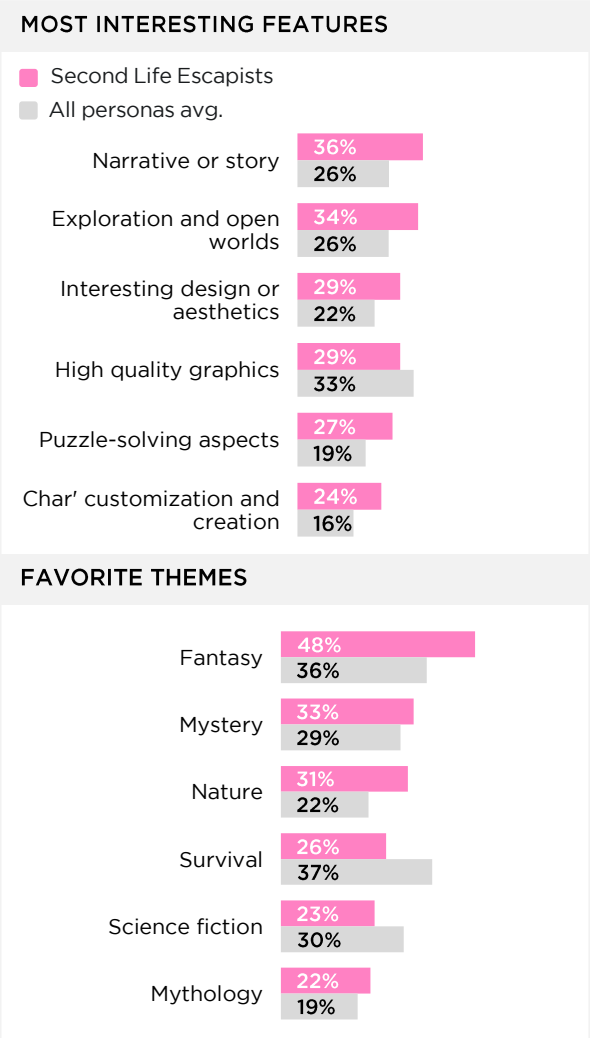
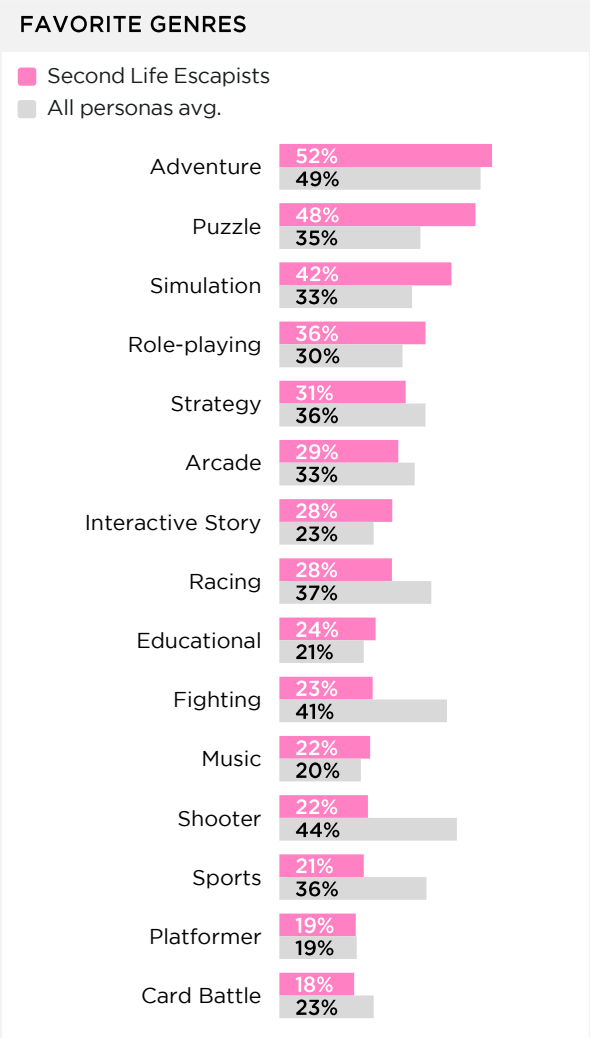
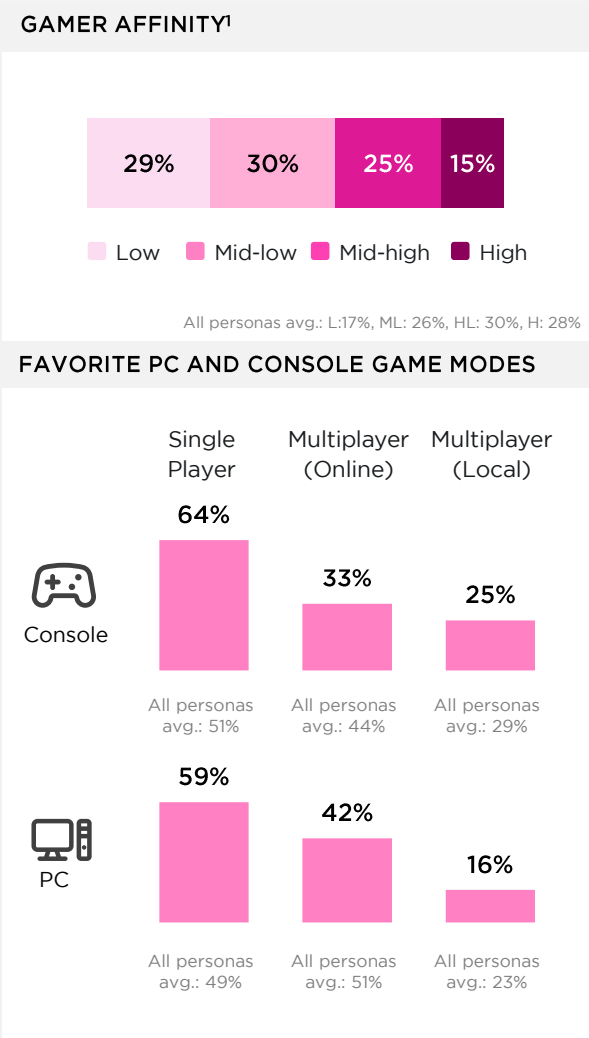
Second Life Escapists

"I'm just living my best (digital) life"

Second Life Escapists enjoy puzzles, simulation, role-playing, and interactive stories, ideally in a fantasy, mystery, or natural setting. They are, however, less likely to have an affinity with the "gamer" label.

TOP MOTIVATIONAL INPUTS:

Avatar, Story, Role Playing, Exploration, Building, Completion, Puzzle



Second Life Escapists: beyond playing



7%

Second Life Escapists

"I'm just living my best (digital) life"

Second Life Escapists are less likely to follow games beyond playing, but they're not far from the average. They rank other pastimes ahead of gaming and generally enjoy a wider range of hobbies than other gamers do.

MOST-REPRESENTED IN:

Japan, Finland, Taiwan, Poland, Sweden, Australia, Spain, France, Belgium, Germany, Russia, Italy

ENGAGEMENT BEYOND PLAY



View gaming content¹
66%



Engage other ways²
30%

All personas avg.: View: 76%, Other 40%

Very likely to explore other media related to favorite games **52%** Personas avg: 59%

Say media/ merch' positively influences gameplay or purchase **46%** Personas avg: 55%

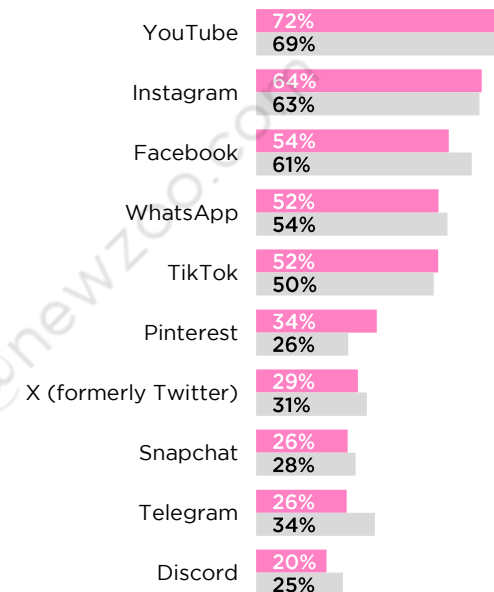
More likely to play a game featuring favorite entertainment brands **59%** Personas avg: 61%

Likely to pick up a game due to a TV show/movie from the franchise **54%** Personas avg: 60%

SOCIAL MEDIA USAGE

Second Life Escapists

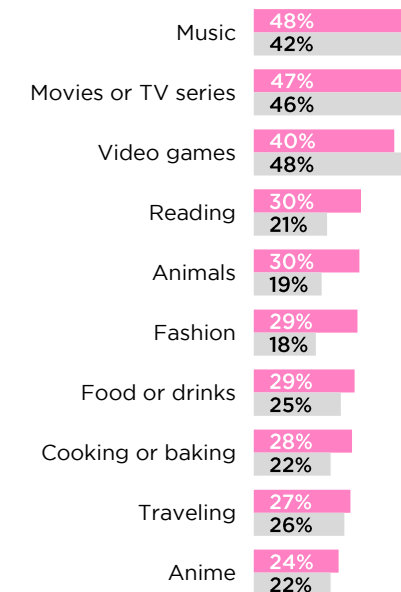
All personas avg.



FAVORITE PASTIMES

Second Life Escapists

All personas avg.



PERSONA SIZE BY MARKET

US	CA	GB	DE	FR	ES	IT	NL	BE	SE	FI	PL	RU	TR	SA	AE	EG	ZA
7%	7%	8%	9%	9%	9%	9%	6%	9%	11%	13%	11%	9%	6%	6%	5%	7%	7%
CN	JP	KR	TW	ID	PH	VN	SG	TH	MY	IN	BR	MX	AR	CO	CL	AU	NZ
7%	13%	8%	12%	5%	6%	4%	6%	4%	8%	6%	6%	6%	6%	5%	5%	10%	8%



Puzzlers & Personal Besters

"I solve problems: if there's a high score for me to beat, even better!"

Puzzlers & Personal Besters naturally enjoy puzzles but also dig competition and other, often sports-related, genres. Mirroring their slight preference for mobile, they're less focused on graphical quality, story, or exploration.

Given their genre and platform preferences, competition among this group is less likely to be head-to-head – instead, these players aim to beat scores or records set by other players or themselves.

Puzzlers & Personal Besters seem to be a more casual group, being less likely to say that gaming is one of their favorite pastimes. That said, they match the average when it comes to how much they identify as gamers, and they are also as likely as any group to view or engage in gaming in other ways. This suggests that they have a genuine interest in games, even though they may not get to play so much nowadays.

Puzzlers & Personal Besters: demographics, playing, and paying



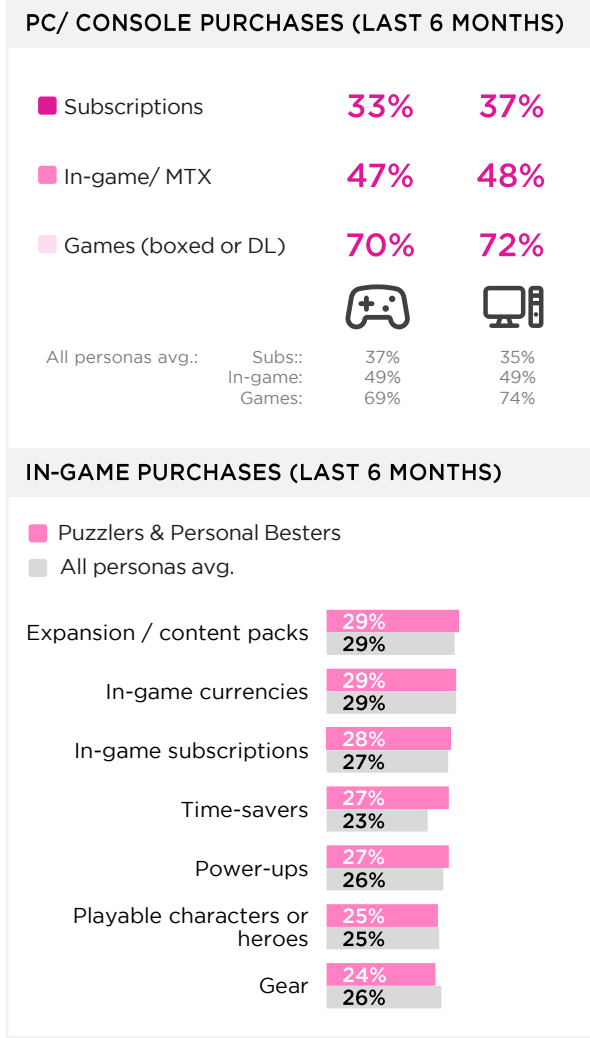
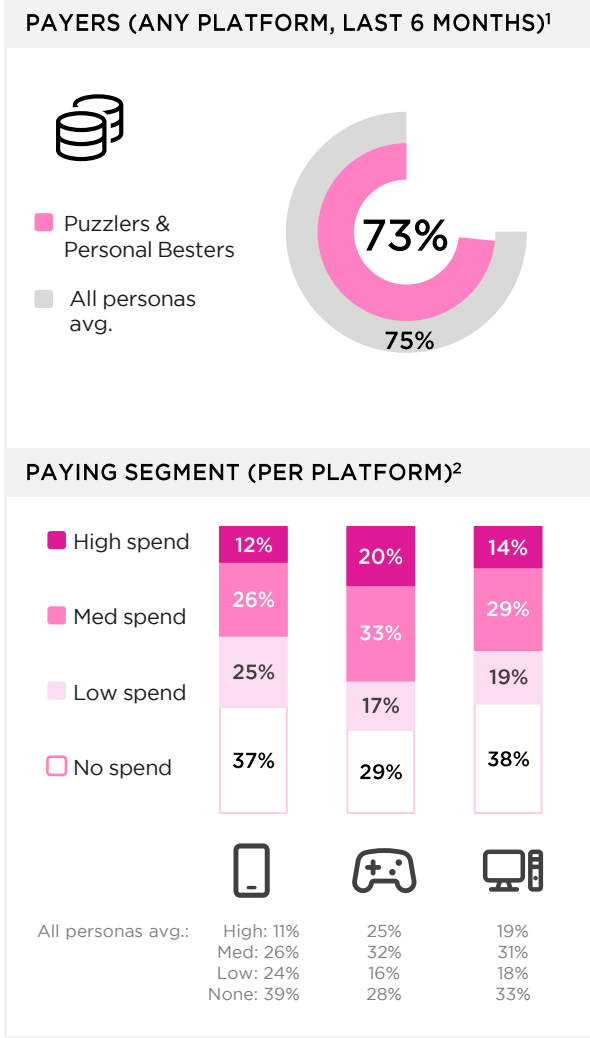
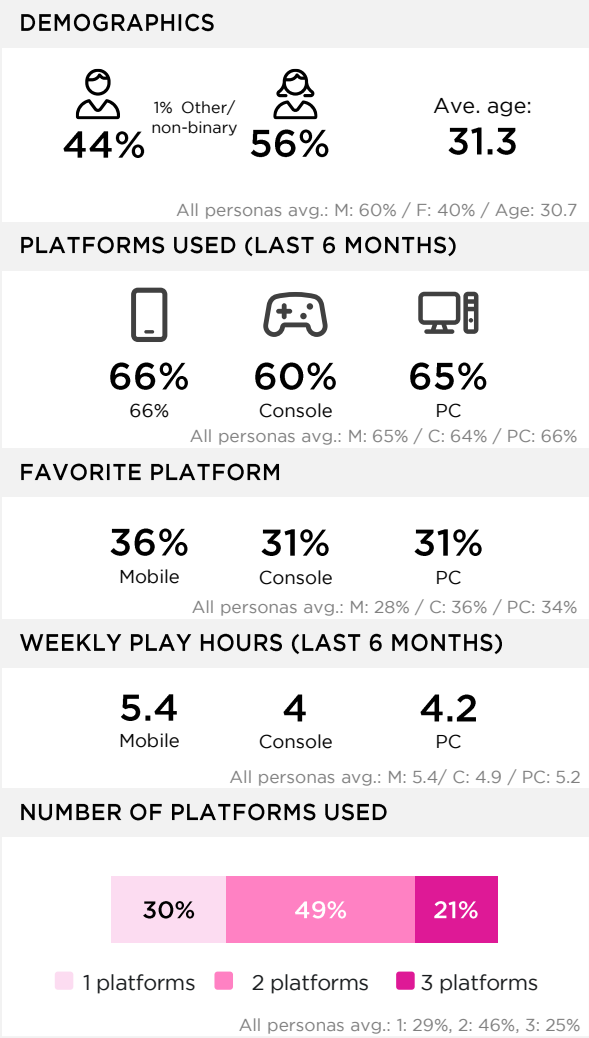
9%

Puzzlers & Personal Besters

"I solve problems: if there's a high score for me to beat, even better!"

Puzzlers & Personal Besters are slightly female-skewed and spend more time on mobile than PCs or consoles, even though they are split on which is their favorite. They are less likely to be payers but more so than Builders and Second Lifers.

- CLOSE COUSINS (BY CROSSOVER):
- Planners & Tacticians
 - Builders, Farmers, & Nurturers
 - Second Life Escapists



Puzzlers & Personal Besters: play preferences



9%

Puzzlers & Personal Besters

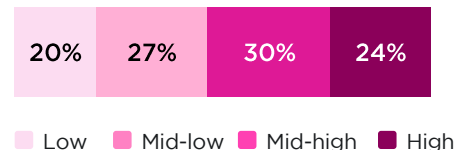
"I solve problems: if there's a high score for me to beat, even better!"

Puzzlers & Personal Besters naturally enjoy puzzles, but they also have a competitive edge and enjoy a range of genres, often sport-related. They're less focused on graphical quality, story, or exploration which mirrors their slight preference for mobile.

TOP MOTIVATIONAL INPUTS:

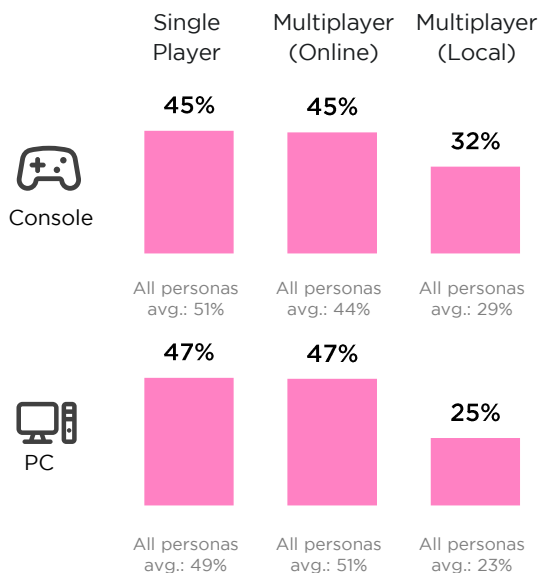
Puzzle, Competing, Story, Strategy, Completion, Cooperation, Exploration

GAMER AFFINITY¹

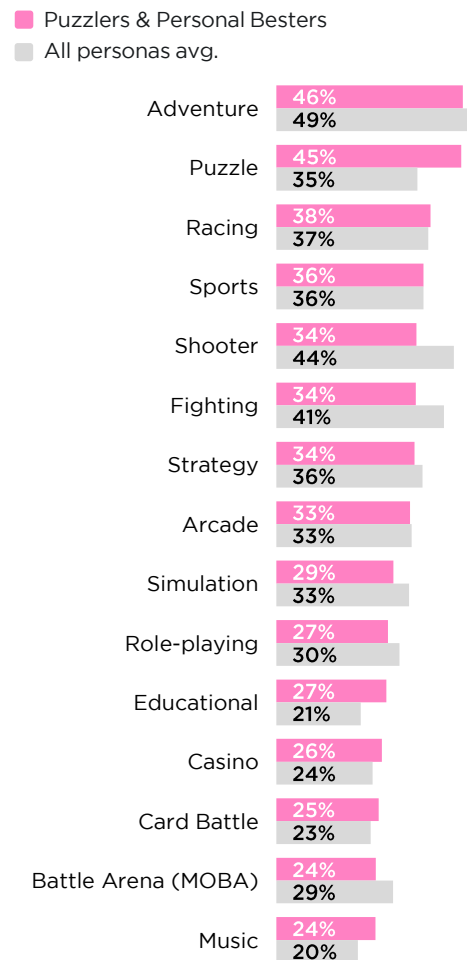


All personas avg.: L:17%, ML: 26%, HL: 30%, H: 28%

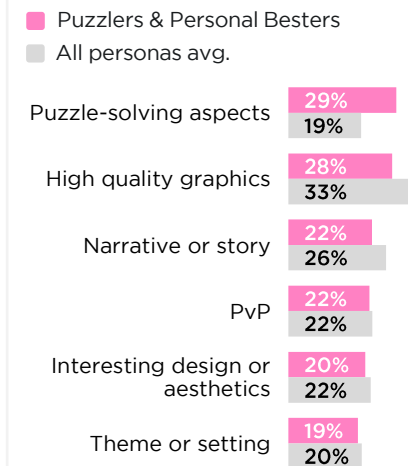
FAVORITE PC AND CONSOLE GAME MODES



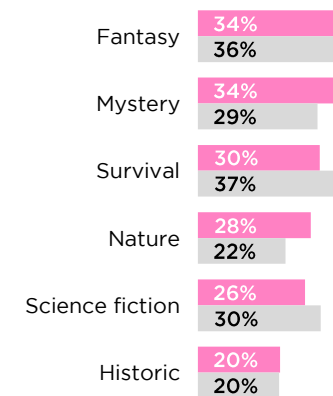
FAVORITE GENRES



MOST INTERESTING FEATURES



FAVORITE THEMES



Puzzlers & Personal Besters: beyond playing



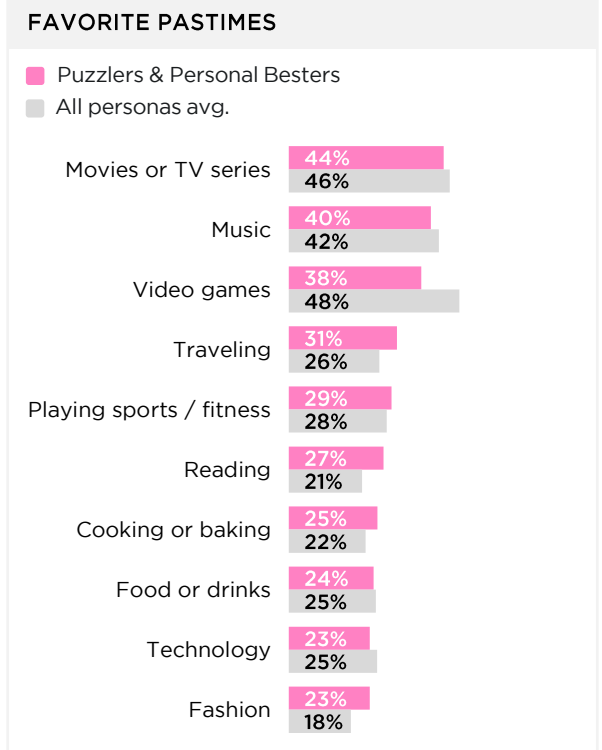
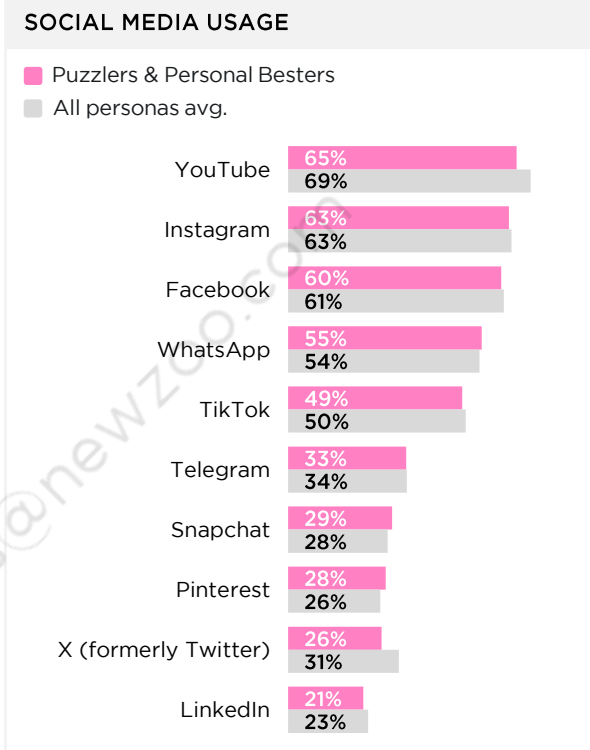
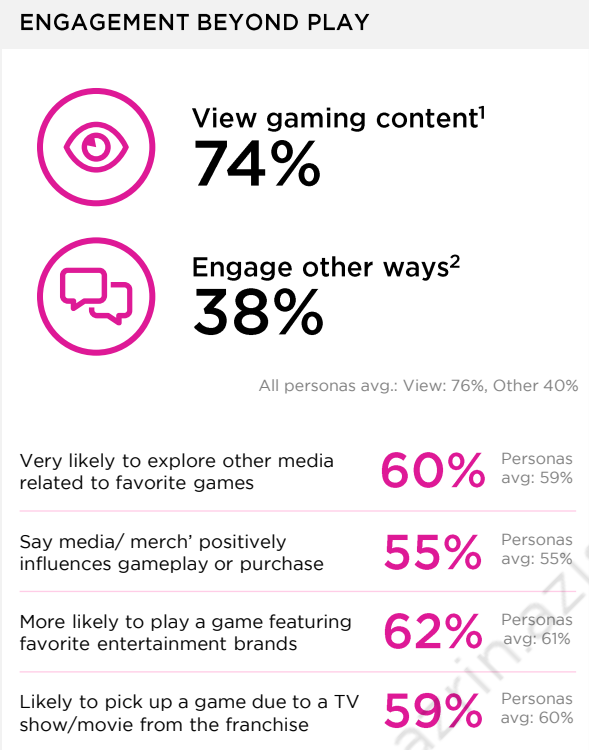
9%

Puzzlers & Personal Besters

"I solve problems: if there's a high score for me to beat, even better!"

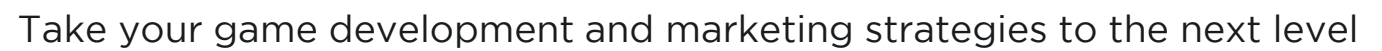
Puzzlers & Personal Besters are as likely as any group to view or engage in gaming in other ways. They are also just as positive about cross-media. They rank gaming below other pastimes and are especially likely to enjoy travel.

MOST-REPRESENTED IN:
Egypt, China, Netherlands, India, Poland, Germany, Japan, Saudi Arabia, Sweden, France



PERSONA SIZE BY MARKET

US	CA	GB	DE	FR	ES	IT	NL	BE	SE	FI	PL	RU	TR	SA	AE	EG	ZA
7%	7%	8%	12%	11%	8%	9%	12%	9%	11%	9%	12%	10%	10%	11%	9%	17%	10%
CN	JP	KR	TW	ID	PH	VN	SG	TH	MY	IN	BR	MX	AR	CO	CL	AU	NZ
13%	12%	7%	8%	9%	9%	9%	7%	7%	7%	12%	7%	9%	7%	8%	7%	7%	7%



How to use Newzoo's Motivational Gamer Personas

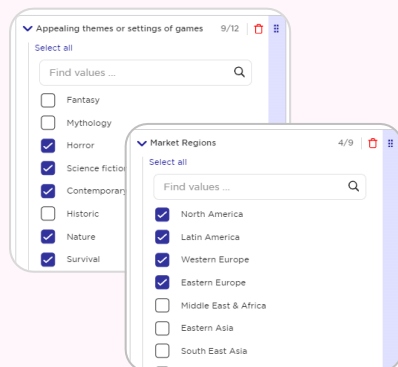
1

Define your audience

- **Start with Motivational Gamer Personas:** Pinpoint the Personas most likely to be interested in your concept, based on the motivations to play you're catering to.
- **Build and refine:** Include or exclude players based on a vast array of data points, like demographics, playing habits, genre preferences, spending habits, engagement styles, social interactions within games, etc.
- **Define your stretch audience:** Understand who else might be interested, by adding in players who have secondary or tertiary affinity with the motivations of your core target audience.



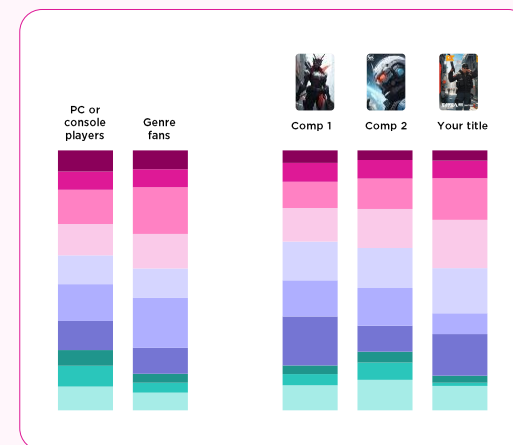
- Hero Protagonists
- Open World Rangers
- Style-Conscious Party Players
- Second-Life Escapists



2

Enhance your offer

- **Inform Development:** Use Personas to understand whether and how your game stands out, next to others in your genre or subgenre.
- **Widen your appeal:** Learn what appeals to players of competing titles, to guide decisions on features or mechanics that might draw in a bigger crowd (especially handy when used alongside data from our [Game Health Tracker](#)).
- **Do the same for content updates:** Being on top of what players like in other games also allows you to create new content to keep them coming back for more.

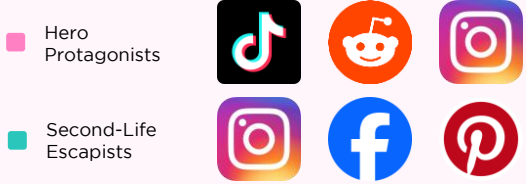
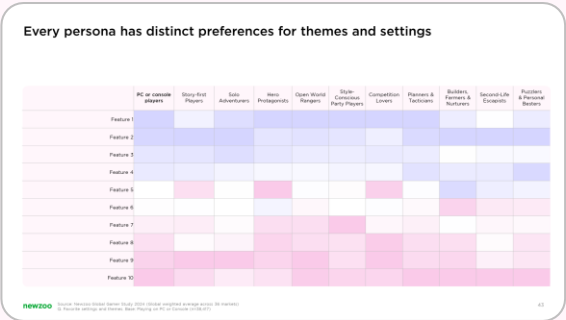
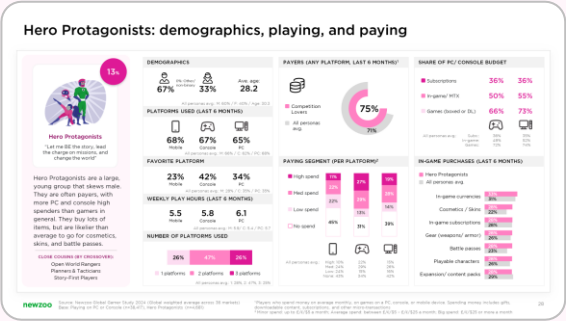


How to use Newzoo's Motivational Gamer Personas

3

Optimize your strategy

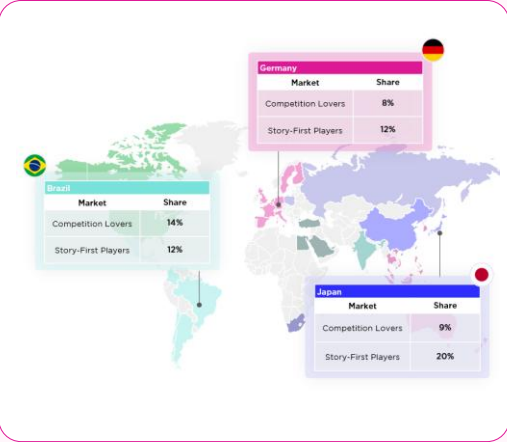
- **Understand your monetization options:** Use Personas and other data points to reveal if and how players are spending money: Are they spenders at all, and are they into cosmetics, season passes, or DLC?
- **Foster your communities:** Design features and events that cater to the needs of your audience, fostering a thriving and engaged community.
- **Target your messaging:** Personas are a great way to learn *how to say what to whom*. Find the most effective ways to advertise and talk about your game, reaching the right players, with the right message, in the right places.



4

Get global and regional insights

- **Go beyond borders:** The Global Gamer Study provides insights from a vast international audience. Use the Personas to identify potential markets where your game can thrive.
- **Adapt for regional preferences:** Use the study's regional breakdowns to adapt your marketing and game features for specific markets



Global Gamer Study

Map the wide world of gamers with motivational gamer personas as your compass.

 **73,000+**
Consumers surveyed
yearly

 **36**
Global coverage
with 36 markets

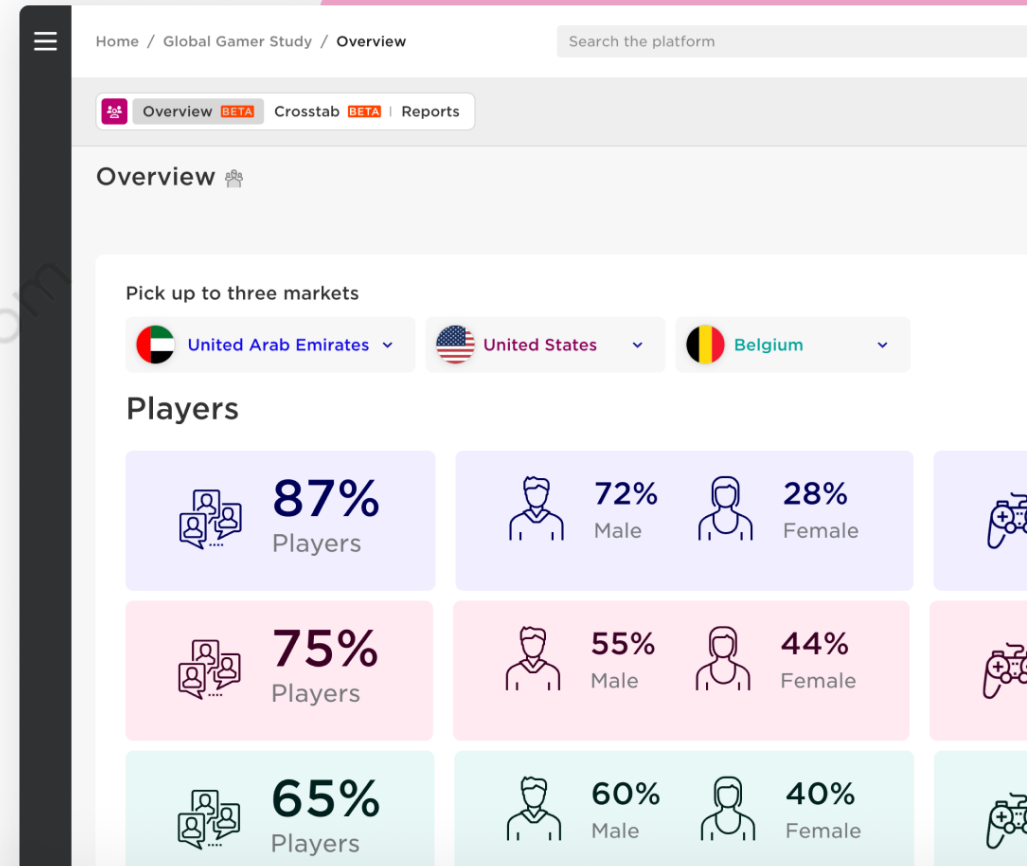
 **200+**
Variables
Tracked

Includes:

- ✓ Full demographic and psychographic profiles
- ✓ Gaming behavior across all platforms/dimensions
- ✓ Playing and viewing motivations & attitudes
- ✓ Spending behavior and motivations
- ✓ Media, lifestyle, and consumer brands consumption
- ✓ Easy-to-use consumer insights dashboard access

Contact your Newzoo client success manager if you have any questions.

[Find out more](#)



Generation Split

Gen Alpha

Gen Z

Millennials



The leading data partner for the games market

PC and console data, gamer research, and consulting

Let's talk